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The Pioneer

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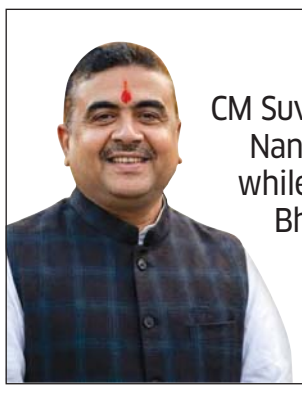
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SC tells Delhi to lift the barriers

Orders withdrawal of Section 163 curbs on large gatherings

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi





The Supreme Court, in a special sitting on Sunday, ordered that Delhi's Metro and railway services run normally, internet access remain uninterrupted, and barricades be reviewed immediately, while hearing challenges to restrictions imposed ahead of protests against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. It also told the authorities to withdraw the enforcement of Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2023, which bans large gatherings.

A bench of Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana also directed that authorities must not detain peaceful, unarmed protesters except through the procedure established by law, particularly outside areas covered by prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the BNSS. It also issued notices to the Secretary in the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA), Govind Mohan; Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar and Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) Chairperson D Thara while hearing a plea seeking contempt proceedings for an alleged violation of the court's direction to ensure that there is no "complete prohibition" on metro and train services in Delhi due to the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protest.

Having considered the submissions of the counsel for the parties and perused the averments in the contempt petition, we think that the petitioners have made out a prima facie case. Accordingly, we issue notice upon the alleged contemnors. They are directed to file a counter-affidavit to the petition, including a compliance report, as per our order, by October 13, 2026. Their personal presence is dispensed with in the meantime," the bench said.

The special hearing on Sunday followed petitions alleging mass detentions, restrictions on movement, internet suspensions and failure to comply with the court's earlier directions on transport services. The petitions also challenged the closure of 45 Metro stations during Saturday's planned demonstration.

The CJP and some student organisations have called the protest against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the functioning of the Election Commission of India (ECI). The Government thwarted a planned mass mobilisation at Jantar Mantar on Saturday after an unprecedented security clampdown and the detention of more than 7,000 protesters, including CJP leader Abhijit Dipke, several opposition leaders and YouTuber Dhruv Rathee.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Present era belongs to youth: PM

RAHUL DATTA ■ Chennai

Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Sunday that the youth are the future of a developed India and the present era belongs to them. These remarks came for the first time against the backdrop of the current spate of protests in some parts of the country, including the national Capital.

Making these assertions, Modi said, "This is your time and your opportunity," adding that he sees the nation's future directly reflected in them.

Emphasising that the global community is actively searching for innovative answers, the Prime Minister told the young minds that the present era belonged to them, as the world looked to them for solutions.

Addressing students during the golden jubilee celebrations of Jaigopal Garodia Hindu Vidyalaya here, he delivered an inspiring talk centred on youth empowerment, national unity, and the timeless wisdom of Tamil heritage.



Prime Minister Narendra Modi addresses the gathering in Chennai on Sunday PTI

He expressed confidence that India's youth have the talent and potential to provide solutions to the challenges and stressed that the youth will play a crucial role in realising the vision of a Viksit Bharat, or a developed India. He said, 'India offers immense opportunities for young people,' and urged them to realise their potential and contribute to the nation's development.

He asserted that the innovative ideas and solutions developed by young people would shape not only India's future but also the future of the world. The Prime Minister expressed confidence that the country could achieve its aspirations through collective efforts.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

The ByStander



Security agencies fear foreign hand in protests

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



As efforts continue to politically address the current spate of protests in parts of the country, especially the national Capital, concerns are rising in the security establishment about foreign agencies or actors trying to stoke unrest.

Given these apprehensions, it is tightening safeguards to counter the emerging threat of external players out to manipulate the political debate to destabilise India, it was learnt. Coupled with this, the law enforcement and intelligence agencies are probing the links between the inimical forces and the protesters, including financial and other related factors, sources said.

The main objective of these actions is to prevent the foreign agencies from trying to weaken confidence in institutions and exploit perceived domestic grievances, they asserted.

The adversarial role of foreign agencies is all the more serious as these street protests now take on alarming proportions due to a cross-border influence operation. Explaining its criticality, sources said this endeavour is "low cost and no risk" because it keeps the perpetrators from being exposed. This is the most important battle lying ahead for the security establishment given the complexities of unearthing linkages, they admitted.

Supporting their concerns, sources said available inputs indicated the protests in the last few months are an externally supported attempt to fan discontent and destabilise the country.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

CJP takes anti-CEC stir nationwide

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Hours after being released from detention, Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders on Sunday vowed to continue their agitation against CEC Gyanesh Kumar, saying the protest would now expand across the country.

CJP's Saurav Das alleged that the Modi Government has created an "emergency-like situation" in Delhi and turned the State against its own citizens. Das said police had illegally detained them without any formal notice and alleged that their phones were seized and they were not allowed to contact a lawyer. He also said he feared someone may have interfered with the devices.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

CJP LEADERS WALK FREE

New Delhi: In the early hours of Sunday, three senior figures of the Cockroach Janta Party stepped out of Delhi's executive magistrate court after nearly a full day in preventive detention. Police took Abhijeet Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das from an aircraft at Indira Gandhi International Airport the previous morning, moments after it landed from Mumbai. Police acted under Sections 126 and 170 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, citing the need to prevent a breach of peace ahead of the group's planned gathering at Jantar Mantar.

FULL REPORT ON >> P5

CJI DECLINES MEET WITH OPPN LEADERS

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Chief Justice of India (CJI) Justice Surya Kant rejected the INDIA bloc leaders' request for a meeting to submit a representation, explaining the reasons for the decision in a response sent to them via email. Sources said that in his reply to the meeting request, the CJI said the issues they plan to raise are already sub judice, being heard in the Supreme Court.

The court has no authority to meet a delegation of any political party at the administrative level in this way, and its power is in fact to hear the petition and give a verdict, the CJI is learnt to have said. He also said the doors of the Supreme Court, as the top judicial body, are "open 24 hours a day for all", and it is "committed to protecting the fundamental rights of every citizen".

Dipke was informed of grandmother's death: Police

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



DCP Neha Yadav addresses a press conference in New Delhi on Sunday PTI

The Delhi Police on Sunday released a video of Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke being told about his grandmother's death. The clip, they said, disproves the claim that he was not informed while in custody. Dipke responded that he was never allowed to use his phone or speak to a lawyer.

Police said they conveyed the news with sensitivity. They said Dipke was offered help to travel to his hometown for the funeral, but he declined. The clarification came after the CJP accused the police of failing to pass on the information.

Dipke's mother had earlier accused the police of lying. She alleged her son was not told about the death of his grandmother on Saturday. CJP leader Ashutosh Ranka also accused the authorities of insensitivity in how the informed Dipke.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

BJP targets CJP over sudden political shift

RAHUL DATTA ■ New Delhi

The BJP on Sunday took on the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), saying the group, which cropped up just months ago and led an agitation over the alleged NEET paper leak and primarily students' concerns, has "suddenly" shifted its focus to an issue related to electoral politics.

"Perhaps you wouldn't see such a fast mutation (change) even in radioactive decay," BJP Rajya Sabha MP Sudhanshu Trivedi jibed, while replying to media queries during a press conference at the BJP headquarters here.

On Saturday, senior BJP leader Ravi Shankar Prasad had alleged that CJP is doing "shadow-boxing" for the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP). Top CJP leaders on Sunday vowed to expand their protests over alleged irregularities during Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.



BJP Rajya Sabha MP Sudhanshu Trivedi

CJP leaders Abhijeet Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das, who were set free on the condition that they would not "breach peace" for a year, claimed their detention was illegal, and said the protest would continue until Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar resigns.

Asked about the CJP leaders vowing to continue their protest, Trivedi said, "Look, everyone has the right to protest, but how much it is accepted thereafter is a different matter altogether."

"Another thing has also become clear; what was a students' movement over the examination system, just two months ago, has suddenly turned into agitation over electoral issues," he said in a guarded response.

"Perhaps you wouldn't see such a fast mutation even in radioactive decay," he jibed, reiterating, "But everyone has the right. Whoever wants to protest may protest," Trivedi said.

Trivedi said the recent victory of the ABVP in various campus polls reflects students' sentiments and the ground reality.

"We have won the Delhi University students' union elections. We also won the Panjab University student union elections. The sentiment of the youth is clearly visible on the ground," he added.

Indian succumbs to injuries in Riyadh attack

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

An Indian national who was injured in the reported attack on Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport on October 10 has succumbed to his injuries, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said on Sunday, conveying its condolences to



the bereaved family and assuring all possible assistance for the repatriation of his mortal remains.

In an update on the incident, the MEA said the Indian national had unfortunately lost his life following the attack. The ministry added that it was in touch with the deceased's family and would extend all necessary support to ensure the early repatriation of his mortal remains to India.

"We convey our heartfelt condolences to the family of the deceased. We are in touch with the family and will provide all support for ensuring the early repatriation of mortal remains," Indian embassy in Saudi Arabia said.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Ramayana in Dogri: A cultural first, a tribute to heroes

MOHIT KANDHARI ■ Jammu

In a proud, historic moment for Dogra culture, the timeless epic of the Ramayana is being performed in Dogri for the first time by the Kargil Shaheedan Ramleela Club, Dhalot of Samba district in Jammu and Kashmir.

The local community founded the club in Dhalot in memory of three young soldiers from the area who were martyred on the same day during the Kargil War.

Bishen Singh Dardi, an award-winning Dogri writer from Samba, is behind the ambitious project.

Last year, he completed a comprehensive 400-page adaptation of the Ramayana in Dogri, written entirely in dialogue form specifically for theatrical staging.

This year, he has decided to stage the Ramleela in the Dogri language.

Dardi served as the director of this local Ramleela club for 14 years. During this time, they staged performances using Jaswant Singh's traditional Ramayana script, which was heavily laden with complex Urdu and Persian vocabulary.

Recognising that the local audiences and actors struggled with these words, Dardi spent over three and a half years translating and crafting an authentic, poetic



Ramleela script entirely in Dogri to preserve local culture and language accessibility.

Krishen Singh, a senior member of the Ramleela Club, said that presenting the Ramayana in the local Dogri idiom, with traditional Dogra artistic elements, will help connect younger generations with their roots while offering senior citizens and the wider community a meaningful cultural and spiritual experience.

Briefing media persons during rehearsals, Bishen Singh Dardi said he has invited all the Ramleela clubs in the area to adopt the Dogri version of Ramleela to reach a wider audience and promote the Dogri language.

In Jammu, a Senior Citizens Support Services Club, Chowadi, is also gearing up to organise a Ram Leela at Panch Mandir, Channi Himmat.

The event forms part of the Club's ongoing efforts to promote Dogri language and preserve Dogra cultural heritage.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Starlink rivalry may cut Ambani's profits: Musk

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi



SpaceX CEO Elon Musk has argued that allowing Starlink to operate in India would benefit ordinary consumers through greater choice, even if it reduced Reliance Industries chairman Mukesh Ambani's profits. In a post on X over the weekend, Musk criticised what he described as contradictory arguments from Ambani's supporters about the satellite internet service's potential impact on the Indian market.

"On the one hand, they say Starlink couldn't possibly compete with the amazing low prices offered by Ambani's de facto monopoly in India and then, in the same breath, they essentially claim that Starlink would be too strong of a competitor! This is absurd hypocrisy and hyperbole," Musk wrote.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | MONDAY | OCTOBER 12, 2026

MCD acts against 1,046 illegal properties in a month, 47 dangerous buildings razed

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Municipal Corporation of Delhi took demolition action against 1,046 properties across the capital's 12 zones between September 6 and October 10, sealing 282 properties and razing 47 dangerous buildings, as the civic body intensified its crackdown on illegal construction under the directions of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the Chief Minister's Office said on Sunday.

The Chief Minister said the ongoing drive aimed to ensure public safety and prevent potential accidents linked to unsafe structures, and directed the corporation to sustain and accelerate the demolition campaign across the city.

According to the data released by the Chief Minister's Office, demolition action was carried out against 158 properties in Rohini, the highest among all zones, followed by 121 in South Zone and 115 in Shahdara North.

Other zones took action against 87 properties each in City-SP Zone, Shahdara South and West Zone; 85 in Karol Bagh; 75 in Central Zone; 63 in Civil Lines; 62 in Narela; 61 in Keshavpuram; and 45 in Najafgarh. On sealing, City-SP Zone recorded the highest number at 87 properties, followed by 41 each in Shahdara North and South Zone. Keshavpuram saw 20 properties sealed, Central Zone 18, West Zone 23, Shahdara South 27 and Civil Lines eight.

Karol Bagh recorded 11 sealed properties, Najafgarh three, Rohini two and Narela one, bringing the city's total to 282 sealed properties. Action against dangerous buildings saw Karol Bagh record the most demolitions, with 13, followed by eight each in Civil Lines, City-SP Zone and West Zone.

Narela and Rohini recorded two demolitions each, while Keshavpuram and South Zone also saw two each. Shahdara South and Najafgarh recorded one demolition each. No demolition of dangerous buildings was reported in Shahdara North or Central Zone during this period, taking the total number of dangerous buildings demolished to 47 across Delhi.

Following a building collapse in Seemapuri, concerned agencies demolished one unsafe building in the area, according to the statement. The Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board also issued notices to three other houses in the locality as part of the response to the incident.

The CM said the campaign against illegal construction and dangerous buildings would continue, with the Government's objective extending beyond enforcement action to ensuring compliance with building regulations and enabling timely intervention against structures posing a threat to public safety.

CM Rekha attends Navratri prayers, warns against holding Delhi hostage

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



On a morning meant for ritual and reflection, Delhi's Chief Minister instead issued a warning: no one, however they dressed up their protest, would be allowed to disrupt the city or damage what belongs to its people.

The Chief Minister visited Jhandewalan Temple on Sunday, the first day of Sharadiya Navratri, where she offered prayers to Maa Bhagwati and performed the prescribed rituals, seeking happiness, peace, prosperity and good health for the people of Delhi and the country.

After extending Navratri greetings, the Chief Minister said the festival of Maa Durga carried a message of faith, devotion, strength, and righteousness, and that the nine forms of the Goddess inspired courage, self-restraint, austerity, compassion, and a commitment to the path of dharma. She expressed hope that Delhi and the nation would continue to progress under the Goddess's blessings.

But her remarks that followed, addressing what she described as attempts to spread anarchy in the city, carried a sharper political edge. The Chief Minister said she prayed that the Goddess would grant wisdom to those who placed their own interests above the nation's welfare, and to those troubled by the country's progress, without naming any individual or group.

She said the people of Delhi had nothing to do with those unwilling to think about the country's interests or take pride in its progress. She acknowledged that everyone has the right to express their views in a democracy. Still, she drew a clear line: inconveniencing the public, damaging public property, or disrupting the city's normal functioning in the name of protest was unacceptable.

That line of argument led directly to her central message for the day, aimed squarely at ordinary residents rather than any political rival. The Chief Minister said her Government remained committed to ensuring the safety and convenience of Delhi's citizens and to keeping the city functioning normally. She said residents would not face unnecessary inconvenience, and that any attempt to hold the city hostage or damage public property would not be tolerated.

She said ensuring the safety and convenience of ordinary citizens, along with maintaining order in the capital, remained her Government's priority, and it would continue working with full commitment to protect the interests of Delhi's people.

1,300 pink e-autos for women, transgender drivers to boost safe last-mile rides

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



A pink electric auto, driven by a woman or a transgender person, could soon become a familiar, reassuring sight on Delhi's streets during the early morning rush or the uneasy hours after dark.

The Delhi Government prepares to roll out its DURGA E-Auto Scheme, putting 1,300 such vehicles into the hands of first-time owner-drivers from these communities.

The scheme, approved by the Delhi Cabinet under Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, stands for Driving, Upliftment and Rozgar for Women and Transgender persons.

In its first phase, 1,170 electric autos will be reserved for women beneficiaries and 130 for transgender beneficiaries, who will own and operate the vehicles themselves.

Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said the scheme was designed to go beyond simply handing out vehicles.

"It is about creating opportunities for women and transgender persons to build independent livelihoods, participate more actively in the transport sector and become self-reliant," he said, adding that the initiative was also meant to strengthen public confidence in cleaner, more inclusive last-mile mobility.

Under the first phase, each revenue district will receive a maximum of 90 electric autos for women and up to 10 for transgender beneficiaries, based on prescribed district-wise quotas and eligibility conditions.

The allocation process has been designed to run through a dedicated digital portal built by the National Informatics Centre, Delhi. Applications will be scrutinised by district-level committees headed by the respective District Magistrates, with verification carried out weekly.

Where eligible applications exceed a district's quota, selection will be made through an online draw of lots to keep the process transparent.

Selected beneficiaries will receive Letters of Intent, along with identification cards, DURGA jackets and caps marking them as registered owners of the e-autos.

They will also be eligible for purchase incentives available under the Delhi EV Policy 2026, and aggregators have been asked to provide free onboarding and subscription support, helping drivers connect to digital mobility platforms from the outset.

AXIS BANK LTD.

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR - AUCTION OF PLEDGED ASSETS BEING GOLD ORNAMENTS

The Borrowers, in specific and the public in general are here buy notified that public auction of the gold ornaments pledge in the below accounts is proposed to be conducted by the Axis Bank at the below mentioned Branch.
That the below mentioned Borrowers has availed the credit facility from the **Axis Bank Limited** against the pledge of gold ornaments ("Gold Loan Facility") in favour of the Bank towards the security. The Demand notices were issued to the Borrowers/Guarantors calling up the Borrowers/Guarantors to pay their outstanding amount towards the Gold loan facility availed. As the Borrowers/Guarantors have failed to repay the outstanding loan amount, the bank is constrained to invoke the pledge and proposed to conduct an auction sale of pledged gold ornaments more particularly described in schedule of property hereunder on **12.11.2026 at 11:00 AM** on **"As In Where Is", "As Is What Is", "Whatever There Is"** and **"No Recourse Basis"**. Auction will be held at

DETAILS OF BORROWERS AND OUTSTANDING AMOUNT

Customer Name	Loan A/c No.	Amount Outstanding (₹)	Date of Recall Notice	Gross Weight	Net Weight
B.O.:- ASHOK VIHAR, NEW DELHI [DL]					
MUDIT SINGHAL	XXXXXXXXXX5538	₹ 17,19,503.90	02-04-2026	185.200	176.000
RAVI VERMA	XXXXXXXXXX3391	₹ 15,70,097.70	16-09-2026	234.500	203.000
B.O.:- BADARPUR DELHI DL					
JYOTI TRIPATHI	XXXXXXXXXX2403	₹ 9,79,484.00	04-08-2026	174.250	163.140
B.O.:- DARYAGANJ, DELHI [DL]					
JITENDER .	XXXXXXXXXX8925	₹ 1,39,316.96	16-09-2026	15.600	14.700
MOHD MOHSIN	XXXXXXXXXX0549	₹ 1,89,646.82	04-09-2026	22.700	21.000
SALMEEN AZIM	XXXXXXXXXX5858	₹ 1,44,031.00	04-09-2026	21.790	17.190
SANIYA	XXXXXXXXXX5943	₹ 2,08,018.00	04-09-2026	21.200	20.500
B.O.:- DWARKA, DELHI [DL]					
VIVEK JEPH	XXXXXXXXXX9771	₹ 74,063.85	16-09-2026	8.200	7.500
B.O.:- GEETA COLONY, NEW DELHI [DL]					
MOHAMAD AKIL	XXXXXXXXXX4504	₹ 3,24,586.00	04-08-2026	69.400	66.600
B.O.:- JYOTI NAGAR DEL DL					
MOHD FURKAN	XXXXXXXXXX3865	₹ 2,73,121.24	07-09-2026	46.480	44.780
YUSUF MALIK	XXXXXXXXXX8708	₹ 12,69,684.82	16-09-2026	141.000	136.600
B.O.:- KALKAJI, NEW DELHI [DL]					
NAIYAR ALAM	XXXXXXXXXX3141	₹ 1,56,212.60	07-09-2026	17.700	16.700
RUBINA KAUR	XXXXXXXXXX9692	₹ 2,03,409.00	29-08-2026	46.600	31.600
B.O.:- KAPASHERA OD DL					
SABITA LIMBU	XXXXXXXXXX0336	₹ 56,690.00	16-09-2026	7.200	6.800
B.O.:- KISHANGANJ OD DL					
VINOD KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX8646	₹ 3,50,277.00	07-09-2026	37.850	36.070
VINOD KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX6547	₹ 2,55,940.00	07-09-2026	25.600	24.500
VINOD KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX7896	₹ 1,64,424.00	07-09-2026	19.450	18.700
B.O.:- LAJPAT NAGAR, NEW DELHI [DL]					
AAROSH KOHLI	XXXXXXXXXX6779	₹ 13,23,161.00	16-09-2026	164.100	151.100
B.O.:- LAJPATNAGAR II, NEW DELHI [DL]					
MANU BARTWAL	XXXXXXXXXX0661	₹ 8,17,099.00	04-09-2026	125.000	117.300
B.O.:- MALVIYA NAGAR, NEW DELHI [DL]					
ARVIND TOMAR	XXXXXXXXXX3846	₹ 18,20,859.00	04-09-2026	214.100	210.200
B.O.:- MAYUR VIHAR, NEW DELHI [DL]					
RAJAT PURI	XXXXXXXXXX9660	₹ 2,34,261.81	04-09-2026	44.700	29.200
B.O.:- MEERA BAGH, NEW DELHI [DL]					
BITTU	XXXXXXXXXX3275	₹ 14,30,966.00	04-09-2026	147.200	139.500
B.O.:- NARELA ,NEW DELHI [DL]					
ASHOK KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX4178	₹ 6,69,825.37	04-09-2026	82.400	67.900
B.O.:- PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI [DL]					
RACHITA MADHOGARIA	XXXXXXXXXX5905	₹ 4,75,619.00	04-09-2026	78.800	76.400
B.O.:- PUSHPVIHAR,DELHI [DL]					
ASHNA NAIYIR	XXXXXXXXXX0336	₹ 9,51,866.00	04-09-2026	129.400	116.950
MADHU BALA	XXXXXXXXXX1197	₹ 32,386.00	29-08-2026	8.400	6.600
VIRENDER KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX8367	₹ 4,06,088.00	04-09-2026	49.900	48.400
B.O.:- R K MISSION, NEW DELHI [DL]					
MEHBUBA BEGUM	XXXXXXXXXX6907	₹ 4,13,716.39	04-09-2026	44.420	41.470
VIKAS KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX0936	₹ 8,88,366.33	04-09-2026	157.590	145.090
B.O.:- SHAHDARA, DELHI [DL]					
UMA SHANKAR PRASAD	XXXXXXXXXX2005	₹ 2,09,284.47	04-09-2026	19.900	19.400
B.O.:- SHALIMAR BAGH, DELHI [DL]					
DEEPIKA SHIVANI	XXXXXXXXXX7238	₹ 1,07,103.77	07-09-2026	19.300	18.150
OMKAR .	XXXXXXXXXX3219	₹ 55,051.09	04-09-2026	19.500	18.200
B.O.:- SHEESHGANJ CHA OD DL					
NAHIM	XXXXXXXXXX8054	₹ 2,08,867.00	07-09-2026	37.980	36.680
B.O.:- SOUTH PATEL NAGAR DL					
GAGAN GULATI	XXXXXXXXXX6124	₹ 1,29,924.00	04-09-2026	22.400	20.500
RAJAN GOSWAMI	XXXXXXXXXX7274	₹ 71,580.00	29-08-2026	7.090	6.760
B.O.:- TILAK NAGAR, DELHI [DL]					
ASHOK KUMAR DHINGRA	XXXXXXXXXX1567	₹ 11,36,280.08	04-09-2026	118.100	112.500
SUDHA RANI	XXXXXXXXXX9647	₹ 11,69,296.41	04-09-2026	175.800	154.800
B.O.:- VIKASPURI, NEW DELHI [DL]					
HIMANSHOO CHADHA	XXXXXXXXXX9905	₹ 1,70,396.26	20-07-2026	36.200	34.400
B.O.:- VISHWAS NAGAR DEL DL					
PRIYANKA	XXXXXXXXXX6295	₹ 78,216.00	29-08-2026	8.200	7.900
B.O.:- DLF, GURGAON [HR]					
SABIR DAFADAR	XXXXXXXXXX4645	₹ 56,265.00	04-09-2026	9.900	9.400
B.O.:- FARIDABAD [HR]					
HARISH SHARMA	XXXXXXXXXX9535	₹ 1,07,092.94	04-09-2026	18.200	17.200
RAKESH JAISWAL	XXXXXXXXXX6324	₹ 10,33,396.50	29-06-2026	228.600	217.000
B.O.:- HAYATPUR GUR HR					
KULDEEP	XXXXXXXXXX9362	₹ 3,78,280.96	16-09-2026	38.300	35.900
B.O.:- MANESAR [HR]					
VIKAS GURAWALIA	XXXXXXXXXX6709	₹ 3,38,283.00	04-09-2026	54.900	46.700
B.O.:- NEW RAILWAY ROAD, GURGAON [HR]					
RUPAM KUMARI	XXXXXXXXXX9840	₹ 73,692.00	04-09-2026	8.600	8.000
B.O.:- PALAM VIHAR, GURGAON [HR]					
RAHUL SINGH	XXXXXXXXXX1085	₹ 1,97,173.39	04-09-2026	48.100	45.200
RAHUL SINGH	XXXXXXXXXX2375	₹ 1,28,664.37	04-09-2026	48.100	45.200
B.O.:- PARADISE MALL S GUR HR					
DEEPAK KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX8752	₹ 5,15,825.00	07-09-2026	67.500	65.100
MEENA DEVI	XXXXXXXXXX9969	₹ 5,75,007.00	04-09-2026	76.300	65.500
B.O.:- SECTOR 10A,GURGAON [HR]					
PASULETI SUMANA	XXXXXXXXXX5017	₹ 1,17,334.60	16-09-2026	18.000	17.500
SURESH PRASAD YADAV	XXXXXXXXXX4508	₹ 85,453.22	04-09-2026	13.200	12.000
B.O.:- SECTOR 14, GURGAON [HR]					
HEMANT GAUR	XXXXXXXXXX5943	₹ 13,87,762.00	04-09-2026	218.800	212.300
NAIMA PARVEEN	XXXXXXXXXX6844	₹ 4,39,980.85	04-09-2026	91.600	89.000
VINITA TIWARI	XXXXXXXXXX1679	₹ 4,76,958.00	04-09-2026	99.100	90.000
B.O.:- SECTOR 16, FARIDABAD [HR]					
AMAN SHARMA	XXXXXXXXXX0418	₹ 5,10,730.05	04-09-2026	51.450	49.050
BABITA YADAV	XXXXXXXXXX8287	₹ 6,86,468.30	18-04-2026	81.500	73.140
DEVINDER BHATI	XXXXXXXXXX8444	₹ 6,35,943.00	13-07-2026	111.100	104.630
MAHESH	XXXXXXXXXX5456	₹ 95,092.00	16-09-2026	10.170	9.870
SAURAV CHAUHAN	XXXXXXXXXX9386	₹ 11,05,628.00	16-09-2026	138.440	134.290
SAURAV CHAUHAN	XXXXXXXXXX9965	₹ 4,22,548.10	16-09-2026	56.000	52.500
B.O.:- SECTOR 57,GURGAON [HR]					
UMESH KUMAR KASHYAP	XXXXXXXXXX8007	₹ 2,16,108.00	04-09-2026	23.600	21.800
B.O.:- GHAZIABAD [UP]					
BHARTI NAGAR	XXXXXXXXXX4358	₹ 5,09,795.00	20-07-2026	79.400	77.000
PUSHPENDRA	XXXXXXXXXX5185	₹ 14,33,453.00	04-09-2026	194.900	171.200
SACHIN GOEL	XXXXXXXXXX4697	₹ 78,290.00	04-09-2026	10.200	9.300
VINAY KUMAR CHAUBEY	XXXXXXXXXX1744	₹ 1,60,133.00	07-09-2026	20.000	19.300
B.O.:- GREATER NOIDA [UP]					
DURGESH PATHAK	XXXXXXXXXX9994	₹ 2,36,923.00	16-09-2026	38.100	35.900
DURGESH PATHAK	XXXXXXXXXX9491	₹ 1,98,975.00	16-09-2026	26.600	25.400
DURGESH PATHAK	XXXXXXXXXX4941	₹ 1,48,718.00	16-09-2026	34.900	33.150
DURGESH PATHAK	XXXXXXXXXX7095	₹ 1,45,513.00	16-09-2026	32.500	25.300
DURGESH PATHAK	XXXXXXXXXX0525	₹ 38,419.16	16-09-2026	32.500	25.300
KAPIL CHAUDHARY	XXXXXXXXXX5217	₹ 44,232.22	16-09-2026	6.900	6.550
MANINDER	XXXXXXXXXX5335	₹ 84,903.00	16-09-2026	15.000	14.250
NAMRATA JOHORI	XXXXXXXXXX6827	₹ 4,89,105.00	16-09-2026	52.500	50.700
PIYUSH SHARMA	XXXXXXXXXX4866	₹ 2,60,524.00	04-09-2026	35.600	33.300
REKHA SHRIVASTAVA	XXXXXXXXXX5797	₹ 9,05,771.00	16-09-2026	111.300	103.300
ROHIT BHATI	XXXXXXXXXX1536	₹ 6,29,035.00	04-08-2026	89.900	86.200
SACHIN KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX9227	₹ 5,49,648.05	16-09-2026	57.300	54.600
YOGENDRA SINGH	XXXXXXXXXX2457	₹ 13,11,295.00	04-09-2026	140.100	133.700
B.O.:- INDIRAPURAM, GHAZIABAD [UP]					
AMAN DEEP KATIYAR	XXXXXXXXXX6531	₹ 5,08,252.00	16-09-2026	86.300	75.000
B.O.:- NOIDA [UP]					
KUMARI NAMRATA	XXXXXXXXXX1968	₹ 25,51,419.00	04-09-2026	442.470	408.940
B.O.:- NOIDA EXTENSION GNO UP					
BRIJESH KUMAR	XXXXXXXXXX3955	₹ 1,05,301.00	04-09-2026	15.200	14.000
MUKEEM	XXXXXXXXXX7738	₹ 2,83,462.00	16-09-2026	41.200	39.000
MUKEEM	XXXXXXXXXX5402	₹ 1,29,933.00	07-09-2026	17.100	15.000
NAGENDRA KUMAR GAUTAM	XXXXXXXXXX8271	₹ 4,23,894.00	07-09-2026	51.700	47.300
NAGENDRA KUMAR GAUTAM	XXXXXXXXXX4947	₹ 3,51,092.00	07-09-2026	56.400	39.400
RASHI PRASAD	XXXXXXXXXX0393	₹ 20,03,108.88	05-08-2026	199.200	193.200
SANDIP TIWARI	XXXXXXXXXX3926	₹ 1,25,873.00	04-09-2026	16.900	16.000
SANJAY .	XXXXXXXXXX9952	₹ 11,83,626.36	16-09-2026	122.700	119.000
B.O.:- SECTOR 12 NOIDA					
KAMAL KUMAR SINGH	XXXXXXXXXX0998	₹ 2,56,398.51	16-09-2026	28.500	26.500
MONIKA SINGH	XXXXXXXXXX5725	₹ 15,16,412.00	07-09-2026	205.700	196.100
NEELAMBARI SACHIN KALE	XXXXXXXXXX8280	₹ 11,16,653.00	04-09-2026	125.400	107.600
SACHIN KUMAR SINGH	XXXXXXXXXX1686	₹ 3,12,425.00	04-09-2026	48.600	44.400

TERMS & CONDITIONS OF TENDER

The Base/Reserve price will be given on the auction day/date to the tenderers on which the auction bid will be considered. The bid/offers in the prescribed tender form provided by the bank shall only be considered for bidding.
Incomplete bid form/tender are treated invalid and shall liable to be rejected.
The tender documents along with the terms and conditions shall be collected from the above branch. The tender document duly completed to be handed to the concerned branch official during working hours on **12.11.2026.** Tenders received after the due date will not be considered.
The said properties is / are offered for sale on **"As Is Where Is", "As Is What Is", "Whatever There Is"** And **"No Recourse"** Basis. The Bank does not undertake any responsibility to standard, purity and /or any other dues, taxes, if any, in respect of the said property.
Tenders will be opened by the Bank on the auction date in the presence of the tenderers who may choose to remain present on the day and time as said above, inter alia, for raising / revising their respective offers.
Branch Names Mentioned Above. Auction Date : 12.11.2026.
Offer/tender once submitted cannot be withdrawn and bidder will liable to deposit the bid amount if there is single bid/ offer for particular article/asset/ornament.
If there are more than one bid for particular article/asset/ornament, inter-se bidding shall take place amongst the bidder and highest bidder shall be declare as successful bidder.
Bidder should submit all KYC documents i.e. PAN Number, PAN Card, Adhar Card & Address proof etc. Bidder should submit valid E-mail ID & Contact Number
The Bank reserves its right to accept or reject the offer at its sole discretion.
Any disputes / differences arising out of sale of the said property/ offered for sale shall be subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of Courts / Tribunals at Mumbai only.

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Man dies after assault in metro; former IAS officer, son booked

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



A dispute over a seat reserved for senior citizens inside a Delhi Metro train allegedly turned violent, resulting in the death of 48-year-old Pawan Sharma. Delhi Metro Police have arrested former IAS officer Sanjay Pratap Singh, 65, and his son, Siddharth Singh, 36, in connection with the case. Both accused have been remanded to judicial custody for 14 days.

According to police, the incident occurred on October 8, when Pawan Sharma was travelling with his mother, Durga Devi, towards Yamuna Vihar. The two were seated on seats designated for senior citizens when Sanjay Pratap Singh and his son boarded the train at Mandi House Metro Station.

A dispute allegedly broke out over the seats and escalated into a physical altercation. At around 5.47 pm, police received information that a person had become unconscious on Platform No. 1 at Supreme Court Metro Station.

By the time police reached Lok Nayak Jai Prakash (LNJP) Hospital, where Sharma had been taken along with his mother, he had been declared brought dead. His death subsequently led to a police investigation into the alleged assault. On the basis of the statement given by his mother, police registered FIR No. 07/2026 on October 9 at the Supreme Court Metro Police Station under Sections 105 and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

The accused have been identified as Sanjay Pratap Singh, a resident of Sector 44, Noida, and his son, Siddharth Singh, who lives in Sector 50, Noida.

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Paschim Vihar Ramlila begins, with message on respecting the elderly

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The annual Ramlila began on Sunday at the DDA Ground near the Radisson Hotel in Paschim Vihar, West Delhi. The festival will run until October 21 and carries a social message for families this year.

The organisers are promoting the idea that when more children follow the path of righteousness and moral values, the number of old-age homes in the country will gradually decrease. Through this message, they want children to embrace religious and moral values and learn to respect and care for the elderly.

On the opening day, the performances included Shri Ganesh Vandana, Narad Moh and the incarnation of Lord Vishnu. Renowned social worker Satish Ram Goel and his wife, Usha Goel, along with other prominent people of the area, performed the stage worship and Ganesh Puja.

According to Yogesh Sharma, Chairman of the Paschim Vihar Ramlila Committee, the Ramlila Mahotsav will continue until October 21.

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has assured the Ramlila Committee that she will visit the festival and watch the performances. Committee members met her on Sunday and formally invited her to attend. Those present at the meeting included Naresh Kumar Aron, former Delhi BJP minister and the chief inspiration behind the committee. Also present were President Bharat Bhushan Dua, Patron Ashish Khandelwal, Lalit Mutreja and General Secretary Ashwini Bagri.

The committee members told the Chief Minister that the Ramlila has been organised continuously for nearly 47 years.

The Pioneer Classified

CHANGE OF NAME

I, SURESH KUMAR, S/o Narayan Das Dhanrajani, R/o Flat No.-502, Rudra Prestige Apartment, Vidhyapeeth Road, Varanasi (U.P) 221002 have changed my name from SURESH KUMAR to SURESH KUMAR DHANRAJANI for all future purposes.

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Sr. Executive Engineer, O&M Division, BBMB, Ballabgarh, Distt. Faridabad	**NIT No. 4/2026-27/ BLB** For Distempering, painting and exterior paint on A,C type quarters, control room and boundary wall at 220 kV Sub Station, BBMB, Ballabgarh.	i) 10.10.2026 at 10.00 Hrs ii) 09.11.2026 at 16.00 Hrs iii) 09.11.2026 at 16.00 Hrs iv) 10.11.2026 at 16.00 Hrs	Rs. 09,05,000.00 Rs. 9,050.00
Executive Engineer Electrical Division BBMB Talwara Township	**NIT No: 05/2026-27** Replacement of defective PVC cable with new XLPE insulated armoured cables at Shivalik Sadan and Community Hall at BBMB Talwara Township.	i) 06.10.2026 at 05.30 PM ii) 02.11.2026 at 11:00 AM	Rs. 4,16,071/- Rs. 8,321/-
Additional Superintending Engineer, Nangal Dam Division, BBMB,Nangal	**NIT No. 221/2026/NDD** Providing parapet wall for protection of muck of spoil bank from erosion in Ghanauli Section.	i) 08.10.2026 at 1700 hrs. ii) 10.11.2026 at 1500 hrs. iii) 11.11.2026 at 1500 hrs.	Rs. 13,18,109.00 Rs. 26,370.00

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The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | MONDAY | OCTOBER 12, 2026

CJP protest: Over 200 detained as marches defy curbs

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA
New Delhi





(Left to right) Security personnel during demonstration organised by the CJP in New Delhi and police personnel detain activists of various student bodies at the Connaught Place area amid continued demonstration in New Delhi on Sunday PTI

Delhi detained more than 200 protesters on Sunday as they marched toward Jantar Mantar and raised slogans. The protest called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) entered its second day amid heavy security deployment across the capital. Detentions continued into the evening, with people being picked up from various locations even after 6.30 pm.

The slogan travelled down Connaught Place's Inner Circle in a steady rhythm: "Gyanesh Kumar isteefa do" (Gyanesh Kumar, resign). Then security personnel began moving towards the marchers. Several who resisted were held by the arms and pulled towards waiting buses. Some were dragged along the road. Others kept shouting as they were taken into custody.

The capital looked different from the day before. Traffic diversions had come into force from 6 am around Jantar Mantar, Connaught Place, Mandi House and Patel Chowk, among 30 points listed in a traffic police advisory. On Saturday, authorities closed the entry and exit gates at 45 Metro stations.

On Sunday, all stations reopened, and trains ran on schedule. Train and bus services were normal. Shops in the markets remained open, though fewer customers came through. The three CJP leaders detained on the aircraft at Delhi airport the day before were not at the protest site. Abhijeet Dipke, Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were produced before an executive magistrate at Delhi Cantt police station that morning and released on the condition that they cause no breach of peace for a year. Dipke left for home for his grandmother's last rites. Das and Ranka went to a press conference.

The day saw a series of flash protests. Different groups gathered at different places and times to try to reach Jantar Mantar. Connaught Place and RK Ashram Marg were among the main sites of demonstrations and detentions. By early afternoon, the marches had split into two groups. One group moved out of Connaught Place's Inner Circle, and another from Rajiv Chowk. The marchers included members of the Students' Federation of India (SFI), the All India Students' Association (AISA), the Krantikari Yuva Sangathan (KYS) and CJP supporters.

AISA protesters marching from RK Ashram Marg Metro station were detained as police kept a heavy presence at several locations to stop demonstrators from reaching Jantar Mantar. AISA president Neha Bora was detained near Vijay Chowk in the afternoon. Visuals showed her raising slogans with other members as security personnel moved towards them. She was seen running as police pursued her, before a few officers blocked her path and caught hold of her.

Women police personnel grabbed her by the arms, while others held her arms and legs and dragged her away. She was also seen clinging to barricades as fellow protesters held on to her. She was eventually detained.

At Rajiv Chowk, the SFI said, its national president Adarsh M Saji, Delhi secretary Sooraj Elamon, Central Executive Committee member Abhijith Manilal and hundreds of members were attacked and detained. The organisation alleged that police took hundreds of its activists to Surajmal Stadium in Nangloi. It also alleged that its leaders were assaulted inside cage-like police vans. Student organisations and protesters described the detention vehicles as resembling small jails. They claimed the interiors were divided into compartments with latched partitions, and that the windows and doors were covered with mesh.

Videos shared by the CJP showed protesters trying to form human chains as police moved in. Police sources said CPI(M) Rajya Sabha MP John Brittas was among those detained. Police have not responded to that claim, according to available reports. The SFI further alleged that Father Biju Xavier, the vicar of Sacred Heart Church in Delhi, was "arrested" while recording alleged police violence on his mobile phone.

The SFI also organised a women's march around 6.30 pm. It later alleged that several women protesters were detained from Connaught Place, and that their detention after 6 pm was illegal. It claimed female protesters were detained by male police personnel. In a series of posts, it alleged that several police vans and buses carrying detained women had no female police personnel inside.

Not every protest was on the road. Social media videos showed KYS members on boats near Nigambodh Ghat, holding posters and calling for the Chief Election Commissioner's resignation. KYS members were also seen demonstrating near Connaught Place. The CJP said supporters had been detained near the Rajiv Chowk Metro station and at Gurdwara Bangla Sahib. It also alleged that doctors and other demonstrators protesting peacefully at the gurdwara were taken into custody.

The press was also caught up in the day. Several journalists covering the protests were detained despite showing press identification cards, according to social media visuals. They were seen showing their cards to officials as they were taken away. The Committee to Protect Journalists said at least six journalists were temporarily detained.

CJP LEADERS TO SEEK FRESH DATE FOR JANTAR MANTAR PROTEST

New Delhi: CJP co-convenor Ashutosh Ranka said on Sunday that he and other outfit leaders would approach Delhi Police on Monday to seek a date for a peaceful protest at Jantar Mantar, a day after Delhi airport detained three of its top leaders ahead of the planned demonstration in the capital.

In a post on X, Ranka said he, along with Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) co-convenor Saurav Das, legal head Ratna Singh and other leaders would visit the Parliament Street Police Station at 10 am on Monday to seek a date for the protest.

"Delhi Police can give us a date for Jantar Mantar in 24 hours, else the CJP will give another protest call," Ranka said.

The CJP planned to protest at Jantar Mantar on Saturday, demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in electoral rolls during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise.

However, Delhi Police detained CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke, Ranka and Das after their flight from Mumbai landed at the Indira Gandhi International (IGI) Airport on Saturday.

The leaders alleged that they were forcibly removed from the aircraft and taken into custody without being shown written grounds for their detention.

Their detention came amid extensive security arrangements and restrictions across the national capital ahead of the proposed demonstration, with the CJP accusing the authorities of preventing the protesters from reaching the designated protest site.

The three leaders were released on Sunday after an executive magistrate produced them. After their release, the trio alleged that their phones had been seized during detention, and that they were denied access to legal counsel, even as they vowed to continue their agitation.

Stick-wielding groups threaten anti-ECI protesters; 4 held for assault

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



A day after saffron-clad groups assaulted protesters demanding Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar's resignation, men carrying sticks were seen moving around central Delhi and threatening demonstrators again on Sunday, even as four alleged attackers were arrested in connection with Saturday's violence.

On Saturday, groups of men sporting saffron scarves and raising religious slogans were seen moving around the protest areas, threatening demonstrators and openly defending the use of violence against those protesting against the Election Commission of India (ECI).

On Sunday, several men carrying sticks were seen moving around Connaught Place, where demonstrations were taking place, confronting protesters and issuing threats. The groups continued to move through the streets despite the arrests made in connection with Saturday's assault.

While four men claiming to be members of the right-wing Hindu Raksha Dal have been arrested for allegedly assaulting students and manhandling women on DDU Marg, videos from Saturday showed larger groups moving around the protest areas in full view of police personnel, openly expressing support for them and the administration and threatening the demonstrators.

The men were heard saying they had come out in support of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and didn't care if police picked them up. They also alleged that "anti-national and anti-Modi" slogans were being raised at the protests, while some described the demonstrators as "anti-national elements" who "deserved to be thrashed".

Groups of men sporting saffron scarves were also seen raising slogans of "Delhi Police tum lath bajao, hum tumhare saath hain (Delhi Police, you wield the baton, we are with you)".

The groups moved around despite prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) being in force.

Thousands of protesters were detained across the capital during Saturday's demonstrations demanding Gyanesh Kumar's resignation over alleged irregularities in the EC's functioning and the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls it undertook.

In one widely circulated video, two men could be seen assaulting a male protester and physically maltreating a woman, pushing her to the ground and pulling at her clothes.

The two men also appear in several older videos alongside Hindu Raksha Dal chief Pinki Chaudhary, a history-sheeter based in Ghaziabad.

The footage also purportedly shows a police officer at the spot. At one point, another officer is seen approaching one of the alleged attackers and apparently whispering something into his ear, following which the man charges towards the person recording the incident.

Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, was among those who shared a screenshot of the purported assault. It was this video that Chaudhary also shared on X on Saturday, claiming responsibility for the attack and identifying the men as members of his organisation.

"These are my workers from the Hindu Raksha Dal, an organisation that delivers on its promises," he wrote, adding that the outfit has the power to set the minds of "cockroaches" straight and would continue to do so.

In another post, Chaudhary described the attackers as "warriors" of Sanatan Dharma and warned that those who targeted it would be targeted.

"We have no interest in politics, but if anyone targets Sanatan, we will target them and send them exactly where they belong," he wrote, tagging the Prime Minister's Office (PMO) and the offices of the chief ministers of Uttar Pradesh and Delhi.

Chaudhary also warned that the Hindu Raksha Dal would not spare those who challenged it and declared that he was ready to protect his workers.

Traffic curbs across central areas amid heavy security

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The second day of the Cockroach Janta Party's protest in the city saw heavy traffic restrictions across Central Delhi on Sunday. According to a Delhi Traffic Police advisory, diversions took effect from 6 am, affecting traffic around Jantar Mantar, Connaught Place, Mandi House, Patel Chowk, and several other key intersections in Lutyens' Delhi.

The restrictions come amid a security clampdown after CJP and prominent student organisations, including the Students' Federation of India (SFI), announced that protests would continue until their demands were met.

The affected stretches include the Ashoka Road-Jantar Mantar Road roundabout, Tolstoy Marg-Janpath crossing, Jai Singh Road-Sansad Marg crossing, Rail Bhawan roundabout, Patel Chowk, Gol Dak Khana and several intersections around Connaught Place.

Traffic movement is also likely to be affected at Mandi House, the Minto Road-Deen Dayal Upadhyay Marg junction, the Lodhi Road flyover, Neela Gumbad roundabout, the Samrat Hotel roundabout, the Sardar Patel Marg-Panchsheel Marg crossing and the underpasses beneath the Bhikaji Cama Place and Moti Bagh flyovers.

The traffic police have advised commuters to avoid non-essential travel and allow extra time for journeys to railway stations, inter-state bus terminals, and the airport, particularly when travelling through New Delhi and central Delhi.

It said it would regulate or relax restrictions based on real-time assessments and urged commuters to follow updates on its official website and social media platforms.

Extraordinary security arrangements remain in place across Delhi for the second consecutive day, with over 30,000 police and paramilitary personnel deployed, as the CJP announced that its protest against Chief Election Commissioner Kumar would continue. Delhi Police detained a large number of protesters on Saturday as it launched an extensive operation to prevent demonstrators from reaching Jantar Mantar, where the proposed gathering was denied permission.

Amid mass detentions, volunteer network offers medical, legal aid to protesters

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



As authorities detained thousands of protesters across Delhi during the CJP agitation over two days, a network of volunteers, doctors, lawyers, and social media influencers stepped forward to help, offering everything from medical assistance to legal aid.

Individuals and coordinated volunteer groups have supported detainees and their families, amplifying social media appeals to connect them with relevant resources. A CJP volunteer said in a social media post that more than 130 people are now working on a protest support initiative after a meeting of volunteers who helped protesters during Saturday's agitation.

"We have about 130-plus people working on this initiative now. So I thought it was time to turn it into a thing," the volunteer said in a video outlining plans to bring different support groups together.

The initiative includes a "Detainee Ghar Wapsi Yojana", which aims to arrange transport and supplies for people returning home after being released from custody, and the Immediate Response First Aid Network (IRFAN), which brings together doctors and volunteers to help injured protesters.

Another initiative, called PAUSE, or People Are Under Systemic Exhaustion, has been developed to connect people experiencing trauma and exhaustion with therapists offering mental health support, according to the volunteer.

The volunteer also announced plans for a scouting team to gather on-the-ground information, a creator network to keep journalists and others updated on developments in different locations, and an information network to collect updates and pass them on to those who need them.



The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | MONDAY | OCTOBER 12, 2026

Will *gherao* police stations if FIRs over Form-7 continue: Karnataka BJP chief

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Bengaluru


Karnataka BJP president BY Vijayendra

Karnataka BJP president BY Vijayendra on Sunday warned that the party would lay siege to police stations and district SP offices if the state Government continued registering FIRs against party workers for submitting Form-7 under the SIR of electoral rolls.

Speaking to reporters after a BJP core committee meeting held in the presence of State co-in-charge Kasam Venkatesh, Vijayendra said the meeting discussed several key issues, including SIR Form-7, the issuance of permanent residence certificates (PRC) by the state Government, bypolls, and the forthcoming Zilla Panchayat and Taluk Panchayat elections.

He said the committee had also decided to appoint district in-charges and constitute election management committees in every district to prepare the party for the local body polls.

Vijayendra alleged that the Congress Government was creating confusion over SIR Form-7 and misusing the police machinery by registering FIRs against BJP workers who had submitted the forms in accordance with Election Commission rules.

He said the Karnataka High Court had also pulled up the State Government over the issue.

"Despite this, if the Government continues to register FIRs against BJP workers, the party will not remain silent. The core committee has decided to lay siege to the concerned police stations and the offices of district Superintendents of Police," he said.

The BJP chief was referring to criminal cases registered at various police stations across the State against individuals, particularly BJP workers and sympathisers, accusing them of filing fake Form-7s targeting certain sections of the society.

Form-7 is a voter application form for objection to the proposed inclusion/ deletion of a name in the existing electoral roll.

Vijayendra objected to the state Government's decision to authorise Panchayat Development Officers (PDOs) and municipal commissioners to issue permanent residence certificates (PRC).

He said the authority to issue such certificates should be restricted to tahsildars and higher-ranking officials.

The State Government should immediately withdraw its decision, he said, adding that the party would write to the Government and bring the matter to the notice of the Election Commission.

With by-elections in Karnataka likely to be announced at any time, the BJP would consult JD(S) leaders and coordinate with its alliance partner before finalising a candidate, Vijayendra said.

The core committee discussed the need to take JD(S) leaders into confidence and ensure coordination within the alliance while deciding on the candidate, he added.

On the forthcoming Zilla Panchayat and Taluk Panchayat elections, Vijayendra said the state Government had already announced the reservation categories, but certain discrepancies and confusion remained in the reservation lists. He alleged that some decisions appeared to favour the ruling party, raising doubts about the Government's willingness to hold the elections.

"The Government should not resort to tactics to postpone the elections by citing various excuses," he said.

Vijayendra said the BJP would begin preparations immediately and appoint election in-charges for every district. He added that district-level election management committees would also be constituted without delay to ensure effective preparation for the polls.

He urged the Government to resolve discrepancies in the reservation lists, ensure transparency, and conduct the elections fairly instead of trying to defer them. Vijayendra said the meeting also discussed whether the existing core committee should continue or induct new members, given the appointment of new party in-charges.

CJP protests attempt to create anarchy: Chirag

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Patna


Union Minister Chirag Paswan

Union Minister Chirag Paswan on Sunday claimed that CJP's protests in Delhi over alleged irregularities in the SIR exercise were an attempt to "create anarchy" in the country, and hailed the Central Government for bringing the situation under control.

He also slammed the Congress for allegedly causing trouble for Delhiites by staging demonstrations on the same issue for the last several days and charged the grand old party with "remaining silent on allegations of sexual assault by a JNU professor who happens to be its MP".

The comments come days after the chief of LJP (Ram Vilas), an ally of the ruling NDA, had said cancelling trains cannot stop India's youth in an apparent reference to the security clampdown in the national capital in view of the October 10 CJP protest.

He had also lambasted the opposition parties for allegedly spreading false narratives and playing politics with demonstrations against the Election Commission.

"We consider protests to be legitimate when people put forward their views peacefully. But if anti-social elements use agitation as a pretext to pursue their own agenda, it becomes necessary to identify them. I believe that yesterday's protest was meant to promote anarchy. In such a situation, the central Government appropriately brought the situation under control," Paswan told reporters here.

He accused CJP leaders of trying to "lead the youth towards anarchy", saying they must be identified and stopped.

The Cockroach Janata Party, incidentally, began as a satirical online campaign against a remark made by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant in the Supreme Court, though he later claimed that his utterances had been reported out of context.

Several protesters were detained by security personnel while marching towards Jantar Mantar from Connaught Place's Inner Circle and Rajiv Chowk in Delhi, as the protest called by the CJP entered its second day on Sunday.

Several CJP leaders were detained on Saturday amid an unprecedented security clampdown in Delhi, with more than 7,000 demonstrators detained at multiple locations as police prevented them from reaching Jantar Mantar in Delhi.

"How many trains can be stopped, how much connectivity can be curbed, how many roads can be jammed...The youth of India have the capability to show the way for the world. Nobody can stop them," Paswan had said.

The CJP and opposition parties have been demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls.

The LJP(RV) chief accused the Congress leadership of doing selective criticism and remaining silent on allegations of sexual harassment against a party MP who served as a JNU professor.

"An MP has responsibilities, and so does a professor - a person whom students regard as a teacher, and in many cases, a figure worthy of reverence. The alleged sexual offences that have come to light are deeply concerning. What is even more troubling is the selective criticism by the Congress," he said.

Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU) on Friday dismissed professor Angomcha Bimol Akoijam, also a Congress MP, over sexual harassment complaints against him, an official order said, even as he termed his dismissal a "witch hunt" and questioned whether due process was followed.

According to reports, at least 11 female students had filed sexual harassment complaints against the professor in May. "Remaining silent in this manner is shameful, particularly for a party that gave the country its first woman prime minister," Paswan said.

The LJP(RV) leader dismissed Congress MP Rahul Gandhi's claims of "vote theft" through the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and an alleged threat to democracy.

"The Congress is unwilling to accept that it has lost public confidence," he said, adding that the party was venting its frustration over electoral defeats.

"The reality is that the Congress has failed to realise that it has lost its footing and that people have lost faith in it," Paswan said.

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Present era belongs to youth: PM

The Prime Minister's message to the youth came on a day when the Cockroach Janta Party vowed to intensify its agitation against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, even as around 200 people were detained during protests at several places in the New Delhi area, which remained under a security chokehold.

Moreover, the Supreme Court on Sunday directed authorities not to illegally detain people gathering peacefully and asked them to ensure the Delhi Metro functions normally and that internet services are not disrupted, subject to law and order conditions. In a special sitting, a bench of Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana also issued a notice to the Centre while hearing a plea seeking contempt proceedings for the alleged violation of the court's direction to ensure that there is no "complete prohibition" on metro and train services in Delhi due to the CJP protest.

Earlier in the day, CJP leaders Abhijeet Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das were released on the condition that they would not "breach peace" for a year. Modi's latest remarks, seen as an outreach to the young, suggest the ongoing protests and demonstrations are unlikely to abate in the coming days.

Meanwhile, earlier in the day, the Prime Minister laid foundation stones, inaugurated, and dedicated multiple development projects worth more than Rs 13,000 crore to the nation in Chennai. The projects aim to improve connectivity, strengthen industrial growth, and create employment opportunities across Tamil Nadu.

Indian succumbs to injuries in Riyadh attack

Earlier, India strongly condemned the reported attack on King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh, describing repeated strikes targeting civilians and civilian infrastructure in Saudi Arabia as "completely unacceptable" and calling for an immediate end to such attacks.

In an official statement, the MEA expressed serious concern over repeated attacks on the airport in recent days, including the October 10 incident, which reportedly caused casualties, injuries and property damage.

"We strongly condemn the repeated attacks on Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport over the past few days, including the dastardly attack on October 10, which have led to loss of life, injuries and property damage," the ministry said.

The ministry also extended its condolences to the families of those who lost their lives and wished the injured a speedy recovery. It emphasised the need to protect civilian lives and safeguard critical infrastructure amid continuing security concerns in the region.

Reaffirming New Delhi's support for Riyadh, the MEA said India stood in solidarity with the people and government of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia in defending the country's sovereignty and territorial integrity.

"We stand in solidarity with the people and the Government of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia in defence of their sovereignty, and hope that peace and normalcy return to the region at the earliest," the statement said.

The death of the injured Indian national has added to concerns over the safety of Indian citizens in the Gulf region. Saudi Arabia remains an important partner for India, with extensive ties in trade, energy, investment and people-to-people relations, as well as a significant Indian expatriate community.

India has consistently called for the protection of civilians and civilian infrastructure during conflicts and urged all sides to prevent further escalation.

The MEA reiterated that attacks causing civilian casualties were unacceptable and called for an immediate cessation of strikes, expressing hope that peace and normalcy would return to the region at the earliest.

Starlink rivalry may cut Ambani's profits: Musk

He added that competition "would greatly benefit the average citizen in India by giving them more choices, as it always does. Ambani's profits will be lower, but he is not going out of business." Musk further stated that market forces would compel SpaceX to price the service affordably: "Obviously, if Starlink is too expensive in India, no one will buy it, so SpaceX will need to make pricing affordable."

The comments are the latest in a series of public remarks by Musk regarding delays in Starlink's commercial launch in India. Earlier, he sarcastically called Ambani "Prime Minister Ambani" and asked whether the industrialist was "the real boss of India," alleging that unnamed "oligarchs" were blocking the service to protect a "monopolistic chokehold." Starlink has sought regulatory approval for several years and has previously signed conditional distribution agreements with Reliance Jio and Bharti Airtel.

India's Ministry of Communications has dismissed the bias allegations, saying the regulatory framework for satellite communications is fair and not discriminatory. They have pointed out that three companies, Starlink, Reliance Jio Satellite Communications, and Eutelsat OneWeb, have the appropriate licences and are at about the same stage. However, final security clearances and spectrum allocation are still pending. Union Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia has said India would not allow a monopoly in the sector.

Reliance Jio, owned by Mukesh Ambani via Reliance Industries, is India's largest telecom operator and has achieved some of the lowest mobile data prices in the world through its aggressive competitive strategy. People in favour of the current market situation often point to service affordability and Jio's scale as reasons satellite services will struggle to gain wide acceptance in urban and semi-urban areas.

At the same time, Starlink and other satellite companies claim they can extend connectivity to remote or poorly served regions where terrestrial networks are limited or too expensive to set up. Jio has also said it plans its own satellite constellation. Reliance has not publicly replied to Musk's comments from the weekend. The exchange highlights ongoing debates about how quickly satellite spectrum is allocated, the balance between existing terrestrial networks and new low-Earth-orbit systems, and the potential impact of extra competition on pricing and coverage in one of the world's largest internet markets. The final commercial launches for the satellite operators granted licences are still awaiting remaining regulatory and security clearances from the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA).

Security agencies fear foreign hand in protests

They pointed out that signs of foreign interference are now emerging in political commentary and social media in the country.

Moreover, sources said reports point to increasing interaction between overseas commentators, international advocacy networks, digital platforms, and domestic protest movements. The role of social media in openly and/or covertly attacking the ruling dispensation is rapidly spreading, and the political leadership has taken cognisance of this factor. While it is handling the importance of using the technology positively, the security agencies are probing its misuse by hostile external factors.

Elaborating on this issue, sources said foreign actors were trying to exploit dissatisfaction through concealed funding, fabricated material, coordinated accounts, or inflammatory messaging. Repetition across videos, articles, and social platforms could make a coordinated campaign appear as spontaneous public consensus. Flagging it, sources said this could lead to social divisions and encourage confrontation between the misguided and the government.

The agencies were examining funding trails, advertising purchases, account-control records, organisational communications and specific evidence of incitement.

They were also engaged in sifting through messages and identifying connections between online coordination and unlawful conduct in any form, including incitement of violence, hate speech, or fake propaganda activities against the elected leadership of India.

The exercise aimed to expose any concealed foreign direction and the hidden role of any foreign Government entity, sources said. The ultimate aim was to deter any external influence or pressure, directly or indirectly, from orchestrating a campaign against citizens, established norms of governance, and adversely controlling the political narrative in the country.

Dipke was informed of grandmother's death...

Meanwhile, police detained over 200 protesters on Sunday as they raised slogans and marched toward Jantar Mantar. Several were seen being dragged into police buses. The protest called by the CJP entered its second day amid heavy security deployment across the capital. Several journalists covering the protests were also detained. They were seen showing press cards to officials as they were taken away.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (PRO) Neha Yadav played the video at a press conference. She said she promptly gave the information to Dipke, along with the time of the funeral. "He was also offered all possible assistance to facilitate his travel to his hometown on humanitarian grounds; however, he declined to avail the same," she said. She added that he was also offered a chance to speak with his family.

In the video, a woman in police uniform and a man in plain clothes talk to Dipke, who sits in a room. He covers his face with his hands. The man offers him water. The policewoman expresses condolences. The male officer asks if he wishes to return home and says the police can arrange a bus or flight. Dipke says, "I will stay."

Dipke's grandmother had been ill for a long time. She died on Saturday at around 11.30 am in Hingoli, Maharashtra.

After the press conference, Dipke posted on X, saying he had asked for his phone for a couple of minutes to find the number of his cousin, who lives with his grandmother. He asked why Delhi Police did not let him use it. He said Delhi Police also denied his request to call a lawyer.

Dipke also made a serious allegation about the night in custody. "At 3.30 in the morning, Delhi Police asked me to call my father and inform him that tomorrow I'll be going to jail for a long time- the same father who has just lost his mother. How much more trauma did you want to put my family through after we already lost my grandmother?" he said. He asked if the purpose was to torment his parents.

CJP takes anti-CEC stir nationwide

Referring to the condition imposed on their release, Das said, "They have said there should be no breach of peace for a year. The breach of peace has been caused by (Prime Minister) Narendra Modi, (Home Minister) Amit Shah and Gyanesh Kumar." "The protests are on.... Protests will happen not just in Delhi but across the country," he said. The CJP leader accused the government of trying to protect the CEC.

"We want to ask Modi and Shah, why are you trying to save Gyanesh Kumar?" he said. Referring to the 2024 Lok Sabha poll results in Varanasi, Das wondered whether Kumar had prior information about the outcome and whether that explains the Government's alleged efforts to protect him. He also slammed Delhi Police personnel for entering Gurdwara Bangla Sahib wearing shoes and without covering their heads and forcibly removing protesters from there. He appealed to the Sikh community to stand with the protesters. Students' Federation of India (SFI) leader Aishe Ghosh also said the agitation would continue despite the restrictions.

CJP leader Ashutosh Ranka said developments over the last 72 hours have reminded people of the Emergency and mentioned railway stations being shut and trains being cancelled. "Even in 1975, trains were not shut," he said, accusing Modi and Shah of turning the agitation against the Election Commission of India (ECI) into a fight against themselves.

SC tells Delhi to lift the barriers

Recording the submissions, the bench said senior lawyers had alleged a "flagrant violation of the directions", citing disrupted Metro services, the closure of New Delhi and Nizamuddin railway stations, the absence of traffic advisories and harassment and detention beyond areas covered by prohibitory orders.

The bench asked Solicitor General Tushar Mehta to ensure the Delhi Metro runs on its normal schedule and that internet services are not disrupted, subject to law-and-order conditions. "Metro trains and railway facilities shall function normally until and unless they need to be regulated, keeping in mind reasonable restrictions envisaged under Article 19(2). Similarly, the court said that free movement of people in the city shall be ensured, subject to the law and order situation and/or traffic regulations. Imposition of barricades on roads shall be reviewed forthwith to ensure free movement subject to law and order and traffic requirements," the bench said in its order.

"Similarly, free movement of people in the city shall be ensured subject to law and order situation and/or traffic regulations. The court said it would review the imposition of barricades on roads forthwith to ensure free movement, subject to law and order and traffic requirements. There shall be no illegal detention, particularly in cases of peaceful unarmed assemblage of people beyond the area where Section 163 BNSS is in operation," read the order.

The court also asked Mehta to ensure that lawyers, journalists and others are not impeded in discharging their professional duties. "Internet facilities shall remain undisturbed, as per law.... When we are saying internet facilities shall remain undisturbed, we are not taking away the powers under the Information Technology Act. "There shall not be illegal detention, save and except by procedure established by law, particularly about assemblage of people beyond the area within which it (section 163 of the BNSS) is imposed," the bench said.

It ordered that a board put up outside its premises stating that section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), which prohibits the assembly of five or more persons, shall be taken down. "We have been informed that a notice board stating imposition of section 163, BNSS, in and around the vicinity of the Supreme Court has been put up. "We direct the authority concerned to take down this board, if not already done, so that citizens as well as lawyers can have access to justice," the bench ordered.

During the proceedings, senior advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing in the court for Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) MP Manoj Jha, told the court that police are detaining people from trains and anyone outside the four-km radius of Jantar Mantar, where prohibitory orders are in place. He told the court that despite the October 9 order, 45 metro stations were closed to passenger entry and exit.

Senior advocate Menaka Guruswamy said around 45 detention centres have been opened in the city and around 7,000 people, including opposition leaders, were detained. She contended that metro stations, namely the GTB Nagar and Vishwavidyalaya metro stations, along with other stations, were completely shut out to the public, and that the court's order was deliberately and willfully violated.

Senior advocate Shadan Farasat, whom the Delhi Police detained during the protests on Saturday, submitted that he was "brutalised" along with a large number of lawyers and said the situation in the city was remarkably suppressive. "It is about the citizens' right to protest. The sense I got yesterday was that we were one step away from a police state. Kindly restore the citizens' right to protest peacefully in the capital. Yesterday, that right was destroyed," Farasat said.

Senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan informed the court that senior advocates Dinesh Dwivedi, Uttara Babbar and Farasat were detained and individuals marching peacefully were subjected to violence. Sankaranarayanan said the court should fully restore free movement, remove all barricades, and restore services at metro stations.

Mehta submitted that on October 10, entry and exit were restricted at only 45 of the 303 stations, accounting for just 15 per cent of the entire metro network. He said the petitions seeking the release of the detainees do not survive, as most of those detained have already been released.

As the hearing began on Sunday, the top court said it would hear all lawyers while addressing a plea seeking contempt proceedings against authorities for an alleged blatant violation of the court's direction on the matter.

The court was also hearing a habeas petition filed by Guruswamy against the detention of political leaders. The court is also seized of a plea by Jha alleging the Delhi Police disproportionately used force during the protests against the CEC and the EC.

The RJD MP has alleged that police indulged in illegal detention, abduction, house arrests of unarmed protesters, student leaders, lawyers, politicians and civilians, as well as "sexual harassment of women protesters". The contempt plea, filed by advocate Shailendra Mani Tripathi, names Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan, Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar, and Delhi Metro Rail Corporation Chairperson D Thara as respondents. The petition refers to the top court's October 9 order, passed while hearing a separate plea against the closure of 57 metro stations and the cancellation of trains to Delhi in view of the protest.

Ramayana in Dogri: A cultural first, a tribute...

Kasturi Lal Gupta, Founder and Chairman of the Club and former Principal of Government Medical College Jammu, has been a key driving force behind initiatives aimed at reviving Dogri.

The Club has previously organised inter-school competitions, poetry sessions, song releases featuring noted artists, and interactive programmes focused on making Dogri a living language in homes, schools, and public life.

Staging the Ramayana in Dogri is seen as a natural extension of these efforts, blending religious storytelling with linguistic and cultural preservation.

Residents and devotees are expected to attend the performances in large numbers as the Club brings the saga of Lord Rama to life in the local language.

Dardi, a resident of Samba with a literary career spanning over four decades and multiple state and national awards, including recognition for his children's literature, has long worked to bring the Ramayana closer to Dogri speakers. He hopes the performances will not only let audiences experience Lord Rama's story in their own tongue but also help preserve and promote Dogri among the youth. Senior members of the club held a special screening to shortlist artists the know Dogri.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | MONDAY | OCTOBER 12, 2026

GRAPEVINE

PMO orders NCPCR hiring



All does not seem to be well in the Women and Child Development. In an effort to cut costs, the Annapurna Devi-led Ministry lectured the country's child protection arm, the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR), leading to the curtailment of services for more than ten consultants. Aggrieved by the WCD action, the terminated employees knocked on the doors of Seva Teerth, as most of them were recommended by some of the like-minded think tanks. Grapevine has it that the PMO intervened and took the Ministry to task, seeking all details of the NCPCR's modus operandi. During the intervention, the PMO was surprised to learn that the commission was functioning without a regular Chairman and Members, and immediately directed it to declare vacancies.

Akhilesh *ko gussa kyon aaya*



Last week, during the INDIA bloc protest at Akashwani Bhawan, Samajwadi Party supremo Akhilesh Yadav left the protest venue abruptly. Grapevine has it that he felt 'bad' over the fact that Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi unanimously decided to enter the Akashvani Bhawan. At the same time, Akhilesh and other SP MPs were being detained. Akhilesh immediately left the protest after getting released from detention, and then he did not turn up for the protest the following days. "SP leadership feels Rahul Gandhi is trying to "own" the fight against the CEC. So, the SP is planning to launch separate yatras and protests in Uttar Pradesh where assembly elections are scheduled early next year. " In any case, in UP we have an upper hand always compared to Congress," quipped a top SP Parliamentarian.

With you, for you, always



While one section has been attacking the force, Delhi Police deserves recognition for how it handled the proposed mass protest at Jantar Mantar. With effective coordination and timely intervention, officers prevented a potential law-and-order crisis from escalating. Barricades held, crowds dispersed without major incident, and the Capital carried on with its daily rhythm. In a city that never stands still, keeping the peace is no small achievement. The men and women in khaki stood firm, ensuring that dissent did not turn into disorder. For their steady vigilance amid the noise, Delhi Police have sent out messages on social media over the last couple of days, even as they faced brickbats on these platforms since the Jantar Mantar protests brought the city to a screeching halt.

ED seeks fast-track trial in Jagan Reddy PMLA cases

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi/Hyderabad





The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has petitioned the Telangana High Court for a day-to-day trial and the personal appearance of all accused in the long-stalled money-laundering prosecutions against former Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister YS Jagan Mohan Reddy and 73 others, arguing that nearly a decade of procedural delays has denied them the right to a speedy trial under Article 21 of the Constitution.

In Writ Petition No 33845/2026, filed on September 23, the agency asked the criminal justice system to speed up the resolution of nine prosecution complaints under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002. These complaints were filed between 2016 and 2021 in the Special Court for CBI Cases in Nampally, Hyderabad. The court has acknowledged all nine cases, but they are still stuck at the discharge-petition stage. Hearings have taken place, but decisions keep getting postponed. According to the ED, this is mostly because of changes in presiding officers and other administrative reasons.

The underlying investigation originated from a CBI FIR registered on the direction of the Andhra Pradesh High Court under Sections 120-B read with 420 of the Indian Penal Code and Section 13(2) read with 13(1)(c) and (d) of the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988.

The FIR alleged that large-scale Government favours were extended to corporates and individuals during the chief ministership of the late YS Rajasekhar Reddy, in exchange for massive investments into companies controlled by YS Jagan Mohan Reddy and his family members. Investors named in the press release include Aurobindo Pharma Ltd., Hetero Drugs Ltd, Indu Projects Ltd., Indu Techzone Pvt. Ltd., Lepakshi Knowledge Hub Pvt Ltd, VANPIC Projects Pvt Ltd, VANPIC Ports Pvt Ltd, Nimmagadda Prasad, Ramky Pharma City (India) Ltd, and The India Cements Ltd. These entities, the ED states, subscribed to shares at exorbitant rates in firms such as Bharati Cement Corporation Pvt Ltd, Jagati Publications Pvt Ltd, and Janai Infrastructure Pvt Ltd.

The agency emphasised that even after considerable time has elapsed since cognisance, there has been no significant progress. In support of its plea for expedition, the ED invoked the Supreme Court's observations in Criminal Appeal No. 730 of 2013 (YS Jagan Mohan Reddy vs CBI). The apex court held that economic offences form a class apart and must be viewed differently, particularly when they involve deep-rooted conspiracies and huge losses of public funds that threaten the financial health of the country as a whole.

"The proceedings have remained pending in the Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy case for nearly ten years, and the chronology of the proceedings itself demonstrates the absence of reasonable expedition in the prosecution of the matter," the ED stated. It sought day-to-day hearing of both the prosecution complaints and the pending discharge petitions "in the interest of justice."

The agency added that further investigation is in progress. The petition places the High Court squarely at the centre of a recurring institutional problem: high-profile economic offences that linger for years in special courts, long after the investigative agencies have filed their complaints and courts have taken cognisance. Whether the Telangana High Court will direct continuous hearings and the accused's personal attendance remains to be seen, but the filing signals the ED's determination to break a decade-long logjam in one of the country's most closely watched PMLA matters.

CJI declines meet with Opposition leaders

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi


Chief Justice of India Surya Kant

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant has not agreed to meet Leaders of Opposition after both of them wrote to him seeking time for a meeting on Monday to raise the 'vote chori' issue, sources said on Sunday night.

Leaders of Opposition (LoPs) in Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha - Rahul Gandhi and Mallikarjun Kharge - had written to the CJI for a meeting with him between 4 and 5 pm on Monday to hand over a memorandum, demanding an end to 'vote chori', CEC Gyanesh Kumar's resignation, halting of SIR and switching back to paper ballot.

"Response of Hon'ble CJI to the letter received from Leaders of Opposition has been sent in their official mail," a source said.

The sources said that the CJI has not agreed to meet the LoPs. They did not elaborate further.

Opposition parties have announced a protest march to the Supreme Court on Monday over their demands. The Congress is calling it "Chalo Delhi - March for Democracy" and said they would converge at 1.30 pm at Connaught Place-Barakhamba Road junction.

In a post on X, Gandhi said the march to the Supreme Court would be by Indians united beyond parties, gender, caste, community and State.

"Yesterday, the nation's young came out in Delhi to peacefully protest. They came with love in their hearts, not hatred or anger. They were beaten, both by cops and BJP goons. This is not the India we want. "Tomorrow, we will march to the Supreme Court as Indians, united beyond party, gender, caste, community and state. Youth, all Opposition parties, civil society groups, all those who believe in democracy and stand by the Constitution of India, will walk with us," he said in his post.

Kharge earlier said in Bengaluru that he and Gandhi have sought a meeting with the CJI on Monday to seek his intervention on the issue of "vote chori".

On Friday, leaders of various opposition parties of the INDIA bloc marched from Parliament to Vijay Chowk and later handed over a memorandum to President Droupadi Murmu.

Speaking in Bengaluru, Kharge also said Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah have "created chaos" across the country, and the heavy police deployment and detentions during protests on Saturday show the Government's "fear" of the youth agitation.

CM Suvendu to remain Nandigram voter

SAUGAR SENGUPTA
Kolkata



Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari would remain a voter in the Nandigram Assembly constituency while continuing as the MLA for the Bhawanipore seat in Kolkata, he said on Sunday at a gathering in Nandigram, where saffron candidate Hansirani Rath won by a record-breaking margin in the just-held Assembly elections. "I will remain a voter at Nandigram till the last breath of my life and at the same time continue as the MLA of Bhawanipore," Adhikari said on Sunday before announcing a range of projects for the region. "I will continue to be one of you and one among you throughout my life," he said.

Adhikari rose to prominence in State politics from Nandigram during the land movement against the Left Government led by then-opposition leader Mamata Banerjee.

Subsequently, he quit the Trinamool Congress in 2021. He contested from Nandigram seat on BJP ticket and defeated Mamata Banerjee, who was the sitting Chief Minister, to become the Opposition Leader of the State. In the 2026 Assembly elections, he contested from Nandigram and Bhawanipore, winning both the seats. He retained Bhawanipore, where once again he defeated Mamata Banerjee. Subsequently, he left the Nandigram seat, from which Hansirani Rath contested on the BJP ticket.

CJP leaders walk free under one-year peace bond as Capital remains on edge

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



In the early hours of Sunday, three senior figures of the Cockroach Janta Party stepped out of Delhi's executive magistrate court after nearly a full day in preventive detention. Abhijeet Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das had been taken from an aircraft at Indira Gandhi International Airport the previous morning, moments after landing from Mumbai. Police acted under Sections 126 and 170 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, citing the need to prevent a breach of peace ahead of the group's planned gathering at Jantar Mantar.

The Special Executive Magistrate at Delhi Cantonment accepted a surety bond of ₹50,000 and ordered their release on the explicit condition that they maintain peace and good behaviour for one year. CJP legal affairs head Ratna Singh confirmed the terms, while advocate Soutik Banerjee noted that the three were free to leave. The party itself framed the outcome as a "major legal victory" after what it called nearly 24 hours of unlawful preventive detention. On X, it declared, "Finally Delhi police is forced to release Abhijeet Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das. Cockroaches never die."

Delhi Police insisted that "all due legal procedures" had been followed and that the leaders were produced before the magistrate within the required timeframe. The detentions occurred against a backdrop of an extraordinary security deployment, more than 30,000 police and paramilitary personnel across the city, that had already led to the detention of over 7,000 people the day before, including former chief ministers Arvind Kejriwal, Mamata Banerjee, Pinarayi Vijayan and Manik Sarkar. The protest itself never reached the designated site; the capital's streets were effectively sealed.

Hours later, Ranka and Das addressed the media at a press conference. Dipke, whose grandmother had died, returned to his village in Maharashtra for the last rites and left the briefing to his colleagues. At the presser, the two leaders said police seized their phones without a proper seizure memo and held them for the full period of detention. They said the devices might have been cloned or otherwise tampered with. Das said they were picked up "as if we were criminals" and taken to separate locations. Responding to the one-year peace condition, Ranka stated that "Prime Minister Modi and Amit Shah were causing the actual breach of peace."

BJP to select civic poll faces from drop box applicants

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Kolkata


Union minister Sukanta Majumdar

The West Bengal BJP has begun preparations in earnest for this year's municipal elections, likely to be held soon after the Durga Pujas, Union Minister and former State party president Sukanta Majumdar said on Sunday, adding the party would be very circumspect in giving tickets to the prospective candidates.

Indicating that the leadership had no plans to pick and choose candidates arbitrarily, Majumdar said that the interested persons could offer their candidatures by dropping their bio-data in drop boxes kept outside the party offices.

"Those who want to contest the civic elections are required to drop their names along with the bio-data in the drop boxes of the respective party offices... only those candidates who are eligible will be selected ... their winnability will definitely be considered for the purpose," Majumdar said, adding that people from cross-sections of the society would be considered before deciding on the candidates' list. "Among the qualifications would be the good image of the candidate in the region... if any candidate thinks that he has already been selected then he will have to regret later... You may think that you are good... the question is what the people think of you," Majumdar, who was earlier made the in-charge of the civic elections, said.

Soon after the festive season ending Chhath, the State could announce municipal elections for the Kolkata and Howrah Municipal Corporations. Besides, elections could also be held for Bally and some other municipalities. Subsequently, the State could hold elections in other parts of the State.

New investors meet West Bengal BJP chief, industries minister

SAUGAR SENGUPTA Kolkata


West Bengal BJP president Samik Bhattacharya

A steady stream of prospective investors has been making a the beeline for Bengal, State BJP president Samik Bhattacharya said on Sunday after a brief meeting with a group of prospective Navi Mumbai investors.

"The world of investors has been closely watching the developments undertaken by the Suvendu Adhikari Government in Bengal ... they seem to be quite confident about the changing atmosphere in the State and have expressed their desire to invest in the State," Bhattacharya, who, along with Industries Minister Tapas Roy, met a small group of businessmen, said.

"We have made it clear that the main object of our Government is to improve the law and order situation, which our Chief Minister has impressively done... we have also said that we will ensure an extortion-free State... we have managed to do it to a great extent though I won't say we have been able to achieve total success... our efforts are on and soon we will ensure a robust law and order situation and free Bengal from extortion which was the characteristics of the previous (Trinamool Congress) Government," Bhattacharya said.

"Minister Tapas Roy and I met the prospective investors, and they have shown keen interest in investing in Bengal... today it was a small meeting in here... after the Durga Pujas they will organise a big programme in Mumbai where we will remain present and meet all of them... and highlight our best points... we are sure Bengal will soon be flush with investors," Bhattacharya, who last month met industrialist Kumarmangalam Birla, said.

The BJP Government was targeting employment generation, which required developing the MSME sector, he said, adding the Sunday's meeting would go a long way in giving a fillip to that cause.

Sunday's development comes close on the heels of Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari meeting Reliance Group chairman Mukesh Ambani and his son Anant. The Ambanis have also promised massive investment in the information technology and semiconductor sector, he said.

IndiGo Delhi-Chennai flight diverted to Hyderabad as power bank catches fire mid-air

ASHOKE RAJ New Delhi

A power bank catching fire mid-air. Passengers scrambling to contain the flames. An aircraft forced to divert. An incident that could have ended in tragedy unfolded aboard an IndiGo flight from Delhi to Chennai on Sunday, raising serious questions about compliance with aviation safety rules and the dangers of improperly stored lithium-ion batteries.

Flight 6E 6115 was diverted to Hyderabad after smoke was detected from a passenger's electronic device in the overhead luggage compartment. The cabin crew used a fire extinguisher to douse the flames, and the aircraft landed safely. IndiGo arranged an alternative aircraft to take passengers to Chennai.

A 36-second video from inside the cabin showed passengers initially attempting to tackle the fire with their bags. The footage, however, does not clearly establish who eventually extinguished it.

In a statement, IndiGo said the crew responded promptly and brought the situation under control.

IndiGo's baggage policy permits power banks and spare lithium batteries only in hand baggage. More importantly, passengers must keep them within personal reach, such as under the seat, in the seat pocket or on their person.

The airline specifically states that these devices "must not be stowed in overhead compartments or checked baggage".

The restriction is not a technicality. A battery fire inside an overhead bin can be difficult to detect immediately, while smoke and flames in an aircraft cabin can quickly create a dangerous situation. Whether the incident resulted from a passenger's mistake, a defective device or another cause remains unclear.



Representative image

Under IndiGo's policy, passengers may generally carry up to two spare lithium-ion batteries, including power banks, rated at up to 100 watt-hours (Wh), subject to security clearance. Batteries above 100 Wh and up to 160 Wh are permitted only for portable medical devices, with airline approval.

The airline also requires terminals to be insulated against short circuits. Power banks must not be recharged or used to charge other devices during the flight.

The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) issued a Dangerous Goods Advisory Circular in November 2025 prohibiting the use of power banks to charge devices on board, including through aircraft seat power outlets. It also requires power banks and spare batteries to be kept out of overhead compartments.

The latest incident comes months after a similar episode involving an IndiGo flight in Chandigarh on March 5, 2026. A passenger's power bank caught fire in a seat pocket after landing, prompting an evacuation. Two fire extinguishers were used to control the fire, and all passengers were safely escorted to the terminal.Power banks use lithium-based batteries that can undergo thermal runaway, a dangerous chain reaction in which overheating can trigger smoke, intense heat and fire.

Sunday's incident ended without reported casualties, but the consequences of a battery fire at cruising altitude could be far more severe. With explicit safety rules already in place, strict compliance, vigilant enforcement and passenger awareness are essential to prevent a repeat of such incidents.

Editor's TAKE

The Nobel goes to the law, not the loudest

By honouring Navi Pillay for her defence of human rights and international law, the Nobel Committee has made a pointed statement in an era of eroding global institutions

The Norwegian Nobel Committee has chosen a jurist over a campaigner. On Friday, Oslo honoured Navi Pillay, 85, "for her efforts to promote peace and international law." Within hours, Donald Trump reshared a Truth Social post accusing the committee of demeaning the prize and branding Pillay a hater of America and Israel. The White House announced fresh sanctions on the International Criminal Court the same day.Pillay's record answers her critics. Born to an Indian Tamil family in apartheid Durban, she became a lawyer in a system built to exclude people like her. She later presided over the Rwanda tribunal's Akayesu trial, the first genocide conviction by an international court, which established that rape can constitute genocide.

She served as a judge at the ICC and as UN High Commissioner for Human Rights from 2008 to 2014, the first woman of colour to hold that post. Her work has been the slow, unglamorous kind: building courts, writing judgments, insisting that the powerful answer to the same rules as everyone else.That is precisely what Alfred Nobel's will asked for: fraternity between nations and the advancement of peace conferences in their modern form. The committee's logic is that peace without law is only a pause between wars. In a year when the rules-based order is being dismantled by its own architects, the choice reads less like provocation than reminder.Israel will say Pillay's chairing of the UN inquiry that concluded Israel committed genocide in Gaza disqualifies her. Israel rejects that finding, and Benjamin Netanyahu has accused the committee of losing its moral compass.

They may dispute her conclusions, but a jurist is honoured for four decades of record, not for pleasing any single government.Now Trump. His case is that he ended eight wars, and his defenders point to ceasefires and the Abraham Accords. Yet the Ukraine war he promised to end on day one grinds on, his designs on Greenland have rattled allies, and he has spent the year undermining international institutions, the ICC among them. Pillay spent her life building those institutions.This is also the year he launched the war on Iran. US-Israeli strikes have produced a conflict now seven months old that has upended global energy supplies. India, which imports most of its crude, pays for it at the pump. In March, Trump told the Washington Examiner he was "not interested" in the prize.

Seven months on, he says he deserves it.Awarding the Peace Prize to a leader in the middle of a war he began would invert its purpose. The Nobel exists to restrain war-making, not decorate it. A medal now would read as a certificate of approval for an unfinished war, and for the idea that might comes before law. Maria Corina Machado's gift of her medal changes nothing; a Nobel cannot be transferred.Pillay joked, on hearing the news, that she might share the prize with Trump if the applause continued. It was a good line. The committee's decision was a better answer.

Navi Pillay: A voice for justice in a world at war

From apartheid-era South Africa to the highest institutions of international justice, Navi Pillay has spent her life defending the vulnerable and challenging impunity. The 2026 Nobel Peace Prize recognises her contribution to human rights and international law, and her enduring belief that peace is impossible without dignity, equality and justice for all.



SANTHOSH MATHEW



"Civilians in Israel, civilians in Gaza, children on both sides have a right to live." These words from Navi Pillay, former United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights, capture the spirit of her lifelong struggle for human dignity.

In a world torn apart by wars and violence, her message is simple: every human life matters, and no one should be denied justice because of their identity or nationality.

Navanethem "Navi" Pillay, a South African jurist of Indian origin, has won the 2026 Nobel Peace Prize for her efforts to promote peace and international law.

Her recognition brings global attention to a woman who has spent decades fighting racial discrimination, defending political prisoners and helping strengthen international justice.

Her life shows that the fight for peace begins with the protection of human rights.

Born in Durban, South Africa, on September 23, 1941, Pillay grew up in a modest family. Her father was a bus driver, while her mother looked after their eight children. Her grandfather had migrated from Tamil Nadu to South Africa as an indentured labourer. The family faced financial difficulties, and the racial discrimination of the apartheid era made life harder for people of Indian origin and Black South Africans.

Pillay refused to let these barriers determine her future. She studied law at the University of Natal and, in 1967, opened her own legal practice. At a time when racial discrimination shaped almost every aspect of life in South Africa, she stood beside those who challenged the system.

She defended anti-apartheid activists and political prisoners and spoke out against the ill-treatment of people in custody.

For Pillay, the law was not simply a profession. It was a way to protect people who had little power to defend themselves. Her work taught her an important lesson: justice must be available to everyone, not just the rich and powerful.

She later pursued higher studies at Harvard Law School, earning a master's degree in law and a doctorate in 1988. In 1995, she became a judge of the South African High Court, marking another milestone in her remarkable career.Her contribution to international justice became especially important during her service at the International Criminal Tribunal for Rwanda.

> HER LIFE SHOWS THAT THE FIGHT FOR PEACE BEGINS WITH THE PROTECTION OF HUMAN RIGHTS. BORN IN DURBAN, SOUTH AFRICA, ON SEPTEMBER 23, 1941, PILLAY GREW UP IN A MODEST FAMILY. HER FATHER WAS A BUS DRIVER, WHILE HER MOTHER LOOKED AFTER THEIR EIGHT CHILDREN. HER GRANDFATHER HAD MIGRATED FROM TAMIL NADU TO SOUTH AFRICA AS AN INDENTURED LABOURE

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She served as its president from 1999 to 2003. The tribunal was established to prosecute those responsible for the 1994 Rwandan genocide, in which hundreds of thousands of people were killed.

One of the most important legal developments associated with the tribunal was the recognition that rape and sexual violence could form part of genocide.

The landmark Akayesu judgment helped establish this principle. It was a major step towards recognising the suffering of women during wars and ensuring that sexual violence could not be ignored in the pursuit of justice.Pillay went on to serve as a judge at the International Criminal Court from 2003 to 2008.

She then became the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights, holding the position from 2008 to 2014. In this role, she raised concerns about human rights violations in conflict zones and called for greater protection for vulnerable communities.

Her message was clear: governments must respect human rights, and those responsible for serious crimes must be held accountable. Peace cannot last when victims are forgotten and perpetrators escape justice.Pillay also supported women's rights through her association with Equality Now, an international organisation working to end discrimination against women and girls.

She contributed to efforts against the death penalty and took part in international initiatives promoting freedom of information and democracy.

Her career reminds us that peace is much more than the absence of war. A ceasefire may stop the guns for a while, but lasting peace requires justice, dignity and trust. When innocent people suffer and serious crimes go unpunished, the wounds of conflict remain open. Independent courts and international institutions can help victims seek justice and make it harder for powerful individuals to act without fear of accountability.

Pillay's Indian roots make her story particularly meaningful to readers in India. From a family whose history began in Tamil Nadu to the highest levels of international justice, her journey reflects the power of education, determination and public service. She has shown that a person from a modest background can make a difference far beyond national borders.

The 2026 Nobel Peace Prize recognises not only Pillay's achievements but also the importance of defending human rights in an increasingly troubled world. Her life carries a message that is relevant to every nation: peace cannot be built on fear, discrimination or silence.

As wars continue to displace families and claim innocent lives, the world needs voices that remind leaders of their responsibilities.

Navi Pillay has spent much of her life being such a voice. Her journey offers a simple but powerful lesson:lasting peace begins when every human being is treated with dignity and justice is denied to no one.

Daiv Vani

WISDOM FOR A MEANINGFUL LIFE

The Best Offering Is the Dearest One

Worship is tested not by what we offer when it is easy, but by what we are willing to offer when it is not.

According to a tradition retold in the Bengali Krittivasi Ramayana, Rama, preparing for the final battle with Ravana, worshipped the Goddess Durga out of season, in autumn, seeking her blessing before he faced a mighty enemy. He resolved to offer one hundred and eight blue lotuses and gathered them with great effort. As the worship neared its end, he found that one lotus was missing. The Goddess, it is said, had hidden it to test him.

Rama did not look for a convenient substitute or quietly shorten his vow. Remembering that his eyes were compared to lotuses, and that he was called Rajivalochana, the lotus-eyed one, he took an arrow and prepared to offer one of his own eyes to complete the number. At that very moment the Goddess appeared, held his hand, and blessed him with victory.

The story does not ask us to harm ourselves. It asks us to look honestly at what we call an offering. Often we give from our surplus, a little leftover time, a little money we will not miss, and then expect full results from half-hearted effort, in prayer, in study, in relationships and in work.

This Navaratri, choose one commitment you have been keeping only halfway, and offer it your best, not your leftover.

–DAIV

PIC TALK



People perform 'Tarpan' and 'Pind Daan' rituals on the banks of Hooghly river near Howrah Bridge, in Kolkata, West Bengal PHOTO: PTI

The gift that goes beyond giving



NAMRATA KOHLI

2ND OPINION

What if a gift could keep giving? Could it have a second life, an afterlife, long after the wrapping paper has been discarded?

I found an interesting answer at the PM Mementos E-Auction exhibition at the National Gallery of Modern Art recently. The gifts and mementos received by Prime Minister Narendra Modi include paintings, sculptures, handicrafts, religious objects and memorabilia from across India. But what interested me was not simply what they were, but what happens to them next.

They are documented, displayed and auctioned. The proceeds go towards Namami Gange. This year, 1,498 mementos have been put up for auction. Previous editions have raised more than ₹50 crore. "Apne uphaaron ka bhi upyog," Culture Minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat told me. Even our gifts can be put to use. "The idea is to create value for a very special cause," he said, describing the Ganga as not merely a river but "jeevan ka aadhar", the basis of life for millions.



There is something powerful in that journey. An object begins as a gift, acquires another layer of meaning through its recipient, finds another owner and ultimately creates value for an entirely unrelated cause.

Standing there at the beginning of the festive season, I wondered whether there was a larger lesson here. Diwali gifting has increasingly become an industry of excess. Bigger hampers, elaborate packaging, imported chocolates, candles, crockery and dry fruits move from office to home and often from one home to another.

We spend enormous energy deciding what to give and remarkably little wondering what happens to it afterwards.

Why should the life of a gift end with its first recipient? Pass it on. Auction it. Donate it. Repurpose it. If something sitting unopened in my cupboard can bring pleasure or value to somebody else, why should we feel embarrassed about giving it another life?

Better still, think about its consequence before buying it. Buy a handwoven textile and your gift supports a weaving tradition. Choose something made by an artisan and your festive budget becomes somebody's livelihood. Gift a book and it may begin a conversation. Give an experience and there may be no packaging to discard. Donate in someone's name and a person who already has everything doesn't receive yet another thing.

A good gift need not be expensive. It should have meaning, utility or consequence.

We talk a great deal about the circular economy in the context of industry. Perhaps we need a circular economy of generosity too.

This Diwali, instead of only asking, "What should I give?", ask another question: "What good can my gift do after I have given it?" Because sometimes the most valuable gift is the one whose value doesn't end when it changes hands.

The writer is an author, podcaster and a Senior Fellow at the Ministry of Culture, Government of India

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

UN warns its employees of unrest in Delhi

The United Nations Mission in India has issued a confidential advisory to its employees warning of a possible civil unrest situation in the country due to protest called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and various student organisations in Delhi.The advisory outlines precautionary measures to be taken during and after a potential civil unrest situation, warning employees of possible rioting, looting and arson.

The advisory comes as the Modi government steps up security arrangements to contain the planned protest, which began as a movement against examination paper leaks and has since broadened to include allegations of electoral malpractice, with protesters raising the issue of 'vote chori (theft)' and demanding the resignation of chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. The CJP and student organisations have appealed to students, young people and members of the public to gather at Jantar Mantar in Delhi for prepare for a prolonged protest.

The Congress-led Opposition has also intensified its campaign against Gyanesh Kumar, staging protests in Delhi for three consecutive days and demanding his resignation over alleged irregularities in the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

BHAGWAN THADANI | MUMBAI

CM Vijay's election case

Every election candidate must truthfully and unambiguously declare his assets and liabilities. It is therefore surprising that, during the hearing of an election petition challenging Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay's victory in Perambur, Justice V. Lakshminarayanan questioned whether alleged discrepancies involving assets exceeding ₹600 crore could constitute a corrupt practice.

The judge wondered whether differences of a few crore rupees could influence voters, given Mr. Vijay's superstar status and voluntary disclosure of his wealth. He also questioned whether an election could be invalidated for errors by a Chartered Accountant assisting the candidate.

However, can a candidate escape responsibility for discrepancies in an election affidavit merely because a professional helped prepare it? Should not the ultimate responsibility for truthful disclosure rest with the candidate, particularly if the discrepancies are deliberate rather than clerical? Reportedly, the petitioner's counsel cited a Madras High Court judgment subsequently affirmed by the Supreme Court, prompting the judge to observe that the "texture of the case" had changed considerably.

Ultimately, electoral integrity demands accountability. Voters deserve truthful disclosures, and the law must uphold this democratic right without fear or favour.

THARCIUS S. FERNANDO | CHENNAI

Metro closure should not disrupt public life

The Chief Justice's observations on the complete closure of metro station entrances highlight the need to balance security requirements with public convenience. Addressing the Solicitor General, the Chief Justice pointed out that the restrictions affected millions of commuters travelling from Gurugram, Greater Noida, East Delhi and South Delhi to different parts of the capital for their livelihoods.The bench acknowledged the administration's authority to impose security measures but questioned the rationale behind shutting down transport facilities altogether. While authorities are entitled to regulate movement and prevent uncontrolled gatherings, such measures should not leave ordinary citizens without accessible transport.Preventive restrictions may be necessary in sensitive situations, but their implementation must remain proportionate to the threat. Judicial oversight assumes importance when administrative decisions have consequences for fundamental freedoms and everyday life. Courts need not direct operational policing, but they must ensure that executive actions remain subject to meaningful scrutiny. Authorities must explain the necessity and duration of restrictions and explore less disruptive alternatives. Security and public convenience are not mutually exclusive; responsible administration must safeguard both.

YASH PAL RALHAN | JALANDHAR

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | MONDAY | OCTOBER 12, 2026

Tourism beyond destinations: Why India's next leap must be built on partnership

India's tourism future depends not merely on showcasing its rich heritage but on building partnerships among government, industry, technology and local communities to create memorable experiences, generate livelihoods and ensure that tourism-led prosperity reaches the people who keep its civilisation alive



GAJENDRA SINGH SHEKHAWAT



India has never suffered from a shortage of destinations. What it has occasionally lacked is the institutional imagination to make the world discover them, reach them, experience them and, most importantly, return to them.

Our civilisational inheritance is almost without parallel: ancient cities and living traditions, sacred landscapes and wildlife, architecture and crafts, cuisine and festivals, mountains and coastlines. Yet tourism is not created by heritage alone. A monument does not constitute a destination; a destination is an ecosystem. It is the road that leads to it, the story that precedes the journey, the hospitality that receives the traveller, the artisan who gives it authenticity, the technology that makes it discoverable, and the community whose participation determines whether tourism becomes an economic opportunity or merely an intrusion.

This is why the next chapter of Indian tourism must be written not in terms of destinations alone, but in terms of partnerships. The old architecture of tourism was largely hierarchical. Governments built infrastructure, destinations were promoted, industry transported and accommodated visitors, and communities remained largely at the periphery. The new architecture must be horizontal. Government, industry, technology companies, creators, investors, States, local bodies and communities must become co-creators of the tourism experience.

The distinction is more than semantic. It represents a fundamental change in how we understand development.

Tourism today is no longer simply the movement of people from one place to another. It is the movement of ideas, stories, aspirations, capital and cultural influence. The traveller increasingly seeks not merely to see India but to encounter it - to taste its food, understand its traditions, enter its homes, meet its artisans and participate, however briefly, in its living culture. That transformation presents India with an extraordinary opportunity. But opportunity without coordination rarely becomes outcome.

The State therefore has a vital, though changing, role. Its responsibility is not to do everything; it is to make more things possible. Public investment in roads, airports, railways, sanitation, digital infrastructure, heritage conservation and civic amenities provides the foundation upon which private enterprise can innovate and invest. Political will provides continuity and direction. Industry contributes capital, managerial expertise, technology and access to markets. Communities contribute what no government or corporation can manufacture: authenticity.

The real challenge is to bring these capacities together.

The Ministry of Tourism's expanding engagement with industry is an attempt in this direction. Eleven strategic MoUs have been entered into, including five exchanged on World Tourism Day 2026. Their importance lies not in the documents themselves but in the capabilities they seek to connect - technology, mobility, hospitality, content, digital outreach and local enterprise.

Consider the changing economics of destination discovery. A generation ago, a traveller might have encountered India through a travel guide or an advertisement. Today, a destination can enter the global imagination through a film, a streaming platform, a creator's narrative or an image encountered on a mobile phone. The collaboration with Netflix demonstrates this new grammar of destination promotion, bringing India's culture, wildlife and mountain landscapes to international audiences. Flavours of India, showcased at ITB Berlin 2026, and promotional campaigns in London and New York illustrate how the geography of tourism is increasingly preceded by the geography of storytelling.

But storytelling must eventually lead to a reason to travel.

This is where the next generation of partnerships becomes significant. Project Varanasi Priceless, developed with Mastercard, moves beyond advertising towards an experience that can actually be discovered and booked: the Ganga at sunrise, classical music, conversations around literature, Banarasi weaving communities and heritage stays. The significance of such an initiative is that Varanasi is presented not as a monument to be photographed but as a civilisation to be experienced.

This distinction should inform our entire tourism strategy. India must move from selling attractions to curating experiences.

Air connectivity is an equally important part of this architecture. Partnerships with Alliance Air, Air India and IndiGo extend Incredible India into the passenger ecosystem itself, bringing destination promotion into flights, digital platforms and international markets.

Technology adds another dimension: intelligence.

The future tourism system must increasingly understand who is travelling, what travellers seek, where demand is emerging and how preferences are changing. The collaboration with Google India, including capacity-building and work towards understanding global travel demand and traveller behaviour, points towards a tourism policy that can become progressively more evidence-led.

Yet the most consequential transformation may occur far away from the traditional tourism centres. If tourism is to become genuinely inclusive, the village must become as important to tourism policy as the metropolitan gateway. The homestay can become as important as the hotel. The artisan can become as important as the attraction. The local entrepreneur can become as important as the large operator.

Partnerships involving Airbnb, Soul of India and MakeMyTrip are attempting precisely this democratisation of opportunity - equipping homestay hosts with digital capabilities, giving lesser-known destinations greater visibility and connecting unexplored villages with creators and bookable accommodation. The underlying proposition is profound: when a destination enters the traveller's imagination, the economic opportunity it creates must enter the lives of the people who give that destination its identity.

This is the true test of tourism-led development. Visitor numbers alone cannot be the measure of success. We must ask a more searching question: Who benefits when a destination succeeds?

Does the artisan earn more? Does the young person find an opportunity locally? Does the woman entrepreneur gain a market? Does the community acquire an incentive to preserve its cultural and natural inheritance? Does the traveller leave with a deeper understanding rather than merely a photograph?

If the answer to these questions is affirmative, tourism becomes more than an industry. It becomes an instrument of cultural confidence and distributed economic development.

India's lesser-known destinations offer an especially significant opportunity in this regard. Technology can bring them to younger audiences; mobility can make them accessible; private investment can create appropriate infrastructure; and community participation can ensure that growth does not come at the cost of identity. Initiatives supporting community-led heritage tourism in the Himalayas, including the documentation of oral traditions, crafts and indigenous knowledge, demonstrate how tourism can become an ally of preservation rather than its adversary.

But partnership must not become another bureaucratic vocabulary for signing agreements. An MoU is only a beginning. The real partnership begins when an agreement produces a product, when a campaign produces a traveller, when a traveller produces local income, and when that income produces greater community ownership of the destination. Industry associations and the travel trade therefore remain indispensable. Their knowledge of markets, travellers, itineraries and distribution can convert aspiration into actual journeys. States and local institutions, meanwhile, determine the quality of the experience on the ground.

The future of Indian tourism will consequently depend upon our ability to dissolve old institutional boundaries - between government and industry, Centre and States, technology and tradition, global platforms and local communities. Varanasi offers a glimpse of this possibility: storytelling, music, heritage, weaving, hospitality and technology converging around a single destination. The larger lesson is unmistakable. India does not need merely more tourists. It needs a stronger tourism society. A society in which the citizen sees tourism not as an industry belonging to someone else, but as an opportunity in which he or she has a stake. A society in which public investment creates the platform, private investment multiplies possibilities and community participation gives development legitimacy.

The tourism destination of the future will therefore not be a place marked on a map. It will be a network of relationships. And India's competitive advantage may ultimately lie not merely in the magnificence of what we possess, but in our capacity to bring together the many people and institutions capable of transforming that inheritance into an experience the world values.

The question before us is no longer whether India has enough to offer the traveller.

It plainly does. The question is whether we can build the partnerships necessary to ensure that every journey into India becomes a journey into its civilisation - and that the prosperity generated by that journey reaches the people who keep that civilisation alive.

The writer is Union Minister for Culture & Tourism, Government of India

Building the foundation for a new generation



ARADHITA SINGH

Not so long ago, news of a terror attack in an Indian city barely surprised anyone, because it had happened before and seemed likely to happen again. One year it was Delhi, the next Jaipur, Ahmedabad, Hyderabad or Mumbai. Television showed the same images: twisted vehicles, crowded hospitals, relatives searching for the missing. For Indians who came of age in the 2000s, this was the background noise of growing up. Terrorism was not a distant border problem. It had reached the markets, trains and streets of ordinary life. For millennials, those years are lived memory. For much of Gen Z, they are a documentary or a story told by parents. That gap matters, because every generation judges its country by what it has experienced. What feels routine to one may be the hard-won result of sacrifice and difficult choices for another.

The early 2000s were hopeful and fragile at once. The economy was opening up and the middle class was dreaming bigger. Yet the 2001 attack on Parliament, the 2006 Mumbai train blasts and the November 2008 Mumbai attacks, which claimed 166 lives, exposed deep gaps in the country's security architecture. The 2008 assault put cross-border terrorism on the global radar and raised hard questions about intelligence coordination and coastal defence.

Reform followed. The National Investigation Agency was set up in 2008, and intelligence sharing and coastal security were strengthened. These steps did not end the danger. The Pune German Bakery blast in 2010, the Mumbai serial explosions of 2011 and the twin blasts in Hyderabad in 2013 showed that terror networks could still strike. The lesson was plain: reacting well after an attack was not enough. India needed to detect plots early, dismantle the networks behind them and treat terrorism as an ecosystem of people, money and infrastructure rather than a string of isolated incidents.

After 2014, the Modi government built its security policy around zero tolerance for terror, with closer intelligence coordination, pre-emptive action, tighter investigations and a crackdown on terror financing. The aim was to neutralise threats before they turned into bloodshed.



Its stance on cross-border terrorism also hardened. The 2016 surgical strikes and the 2019 Balakot air strike showed a readiness to respond militarily to major attacks. Counterterrorism became tied more openly to deterrence, and the message was that terror would now carry costs well beyond diplomatic protest.

Set against the 2000s, the change is visible. The serial bombings that repeatedly rocked India's big cities have become far rarer. Terrorism has not vanished, and threats in Jammu and Kashmir and elsewhere demand constant alertness. Still, the distance from that earlier decade is significant.

Gen Z feels this in everyday life. Commuting to college, riding the metro, strolling through a mall, attending a concert or booking a holiday all rest, in part, on a sense that public places are safe. Few people think about the institutions that make this possible. For a generation raised amid widening opportunity, planning a future without bracing for the next big attack can feel normal. But that confidence is neither automatic nor guaranteed.

Security and development are also bound together. Factories need secure supply chains, tourism needs public trust, and digital payments need defences against cyber threats. National security is not separate from development; it is one of the conditions that allows development to continue.

The past decade has brought a major expansion of highways, airports, railways and digital public infrastructure. UPI has transformed everyday payments. Their durability depends on the state's ability to protect critical infrastructure and respond to new threats.

That link grows stronger as India aims to become a developed nation by 2047. Building creates opportunity; protecting what has been built allows it to last. India's success will be judged not only by how much it builds, but by how well it safeguards it.

India's standing in the world tells a similar story. In the 2000s, major attacks repeatedly put its security weaknesses under the global spotlight. Today its international role spans economic partnerships, technology cooperation and diplomacy, and its 2023 G20 presidency offered a prominent stage for that growing role. Influence abroad draws on economic and technological strength, but credibility rests on a country's ability to protect its people and interests.

For young people raised on digital payments, new infrastructure and widening horizons, all of this can look like progress taking its natural course. It is not. The security environment in which a country grows is neither automatic nor permanent. It depends on policy choices, institutional strength and the unrelenting work of those entrusted with protecting the nation. India's counterterrorism journey has been shaped by reforms and security institutions across successive governments. Since 2014, the Modi government's focus on stronger capabilities, preventive action and a more assertive strategic posture has become a defining feature of it. Holding on to these gains demands sustained vigilance, because terrorist networks keep adapting.

As India heads towards 2047, today's young will inherit both the opportunities development has created and the duty to preserve the conditions behind them.

For millennials, the fears of the 2000s are lived experience. For many in Gen Z, they are fast becoming history.

Real progress is not a generation that has forgotten fear, but one with the confidence to dream beyond it. For those spared the anxieties of their elders, understanding the journey from vulnerability to resilience is the surest way to value the peace they have inherited.

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From media monopoly to nationalist narrative: India's information revolution



MANOJ RAGHUVANSHI

Nationalist media's evolution, at the speed of revolution, has shaken up the Indian information landscape. A quarter of a century ago, we were subjected to the opinions of "liberal", "secular", "progressive" "intellectuals". They crafted interpretation of news. They analysed events, and they even chose the facts which must be brought upfront. Leftist historians had already "educated" the Indian mind to be susceptible to lies and distortion of reality. On August 25, 2003, terrorist blasts at Gateway of India killed 54 innocent people, and injured 244. The most 'liberal', therefore the most respected, channel gave a surreal colour to the developing news. It declared that the stock market had bounced back.

Leftists infested this channel. They were the elite of the media. Naturally, aspiring young journalists looked up to them, and tried to emulate them. Success was succeeding like success. Each time, after a fresh extremist incident, the theme of this channel was that the share market has stabilized. In not so supressed tones, the message was that those who had invested money in businesses had nothing to worry. They are not the victims.

The victim is the other (man in the street). This nonsense continued until the 26th of November, 2008.

This time, the terrorists crossed the road from Gateway of India, to Hotel Taj. Now it was not possible to convince the investor that he is still safe. The channel's stock market absurdity stopped. The remaining media was not radically different. Newspapers, magazines and television channels were dominated by 'secularists'. Their reportage may have been hurtful to the nationalists. But that lopsided reportage was rewarded by some top guns. Exactly 76 days after the terrorist attack on Indian Parliament, on February 27, 2002, 'kar sevaks' returning from Ayodhya were trapped in Sabarmati Express, which had been halted by chain-pulling just off the Godhra station in Gujarat. Doors were jammed and an extremely violent mob of stone pelters attacked the train from both sides. Inflammable liquid was poured into S-6 coach and the bogey was torched. There was no way to escape.

A total of 58 passengers were burnt alive inside the train, and one died on the way to the hospital. The dead included 27 women and 10 children. The incident happened around eight in the morning. Meaning, there was a full day, until late evening, to write an editorial.

One of the leading newspapers of India, whose name included a synonym of Bharat, wrote its editorial for the next morning. In that editorial, there was not a single word of condemnation for the obvious culprits, and not a single word of sympathy for the innocent victims. When the Ayodhya imbroglio was at its peak, the leading news magazine of the country did a cover story which offered a hundred "creative" solutions to the problem.



They ranged from building a hospital, a library, a playground to a toilet. The only option they did not include was building Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Mandir at the spot. This magazine also contained a synonym of Bharat in its title. The same magazine later launched a leading television news channel. This channel invited terrorist Yasin Malik on its stage, and openly conferred upon him an award. Yasin Malik was portrayed as the "Youth Icon" of the country. This was exactly 256 days before the 26/11 attack in Mumbai. All this time, the audience, which is primarily nationalistic in spirit, was compelled to take it because puppets, who ruled the media, were controlled by a power centre which was antithetical to nationalism. The clear divide between the mainstream media of yesterday, and its metamorphosed version of today, is that the earlier version played down the word 'jihad'. In its stead, it always held that a frank discussion on Islamic terrorism was a violation of 'Ganga-Jamuni tehzeeb' (which had never existed in reality). Before the onset of nationalist media, the moment you raised the subject of a 'jihadi' attack, the 'progressives' warned you that you were threating the "unity and integrity" of the country. Translated into simple language, the refrain meant that the thought of self-defence was actually against the interest of our own country. Blow by blow, this diseased narrative has now been almost silenced by the nationalists.

The idea of threatening the unity and integrity of India was perverse, but the elite 'secularists' emphasised it with such conviction, and at such high decibels, that the fence sitters among the audience felt scared. Another partition meant another massacre, this time perhaps in crores.

The threat clearly meant that those who had dismembered the country earlier, will dismember it again, if we, even verbally, objected to 'jihad'. The pre-nationalist media propounded yet another specious argument. Every time the vexatious issue of Kashmir cropped up, it was suggested that we should talk to "Kashmiris". It was a clever twist. If talking to "Kashmiris" was ever necessary, it should have included talking to Kashmiri Hindus. But the leftists who dominated the pre-nationalist media, never, for a moment, suggested that we should talk to Kashmiri Hindus. For the 'liberal' media, talking to "Kashmiris" meant talking to Kashmiri Muslims only. The glib argument survived because it was not challenged. The momentum of the leftist-secularist media was so great that objections were suppressed in the noise.

Talking to Kashmiri Muslims alone was neither just, nor politically wise. Kashmiri Hindus were equal stakeholders in Kashmir. And, because they had been victimised, they should have been heard first. But, on the issue of secession, talking to Kashmiri Hindus would have got only one response: that Kashmir was, and is, an integral part of the country. This was not what the 'liberal' media was willing to hear. Hence, the cunning line: Let's talk to Kashmiri (Muslims). The 'progressive' media began to shriek at Vivek Agnihotri for making 'The Kashmir Files'. He was demonized as a propagandist. But that media had lost its relevance. It shut up when asked why it had conspired to remain silent on the genocide and exodus of Kashmiri Pandits.

The writer is a political analyst

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A Capital under siege, an ECI under scrutiny: The legal war behind the street unrest



RANJIT KUMAR SINHA

The week gone by witnessed massive protests, agitations, and an unprecedented security crackdown in New Delhi, paralysing normal life.

Authorities designated roads and streets leading to Jantar Mantar as prohibited zones, enforced internet shutdowns within a four-kilometer radius, and cancelled several incoming trains to restrict entry into the capital.

What began as opposition parties taking to the streets-culminating in a peace march to Raj Ghat-escalated when groups like the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) called for a mass rally at Jantar Mantar, prompting security forces to erect elaborate barricades.

At the center of this widespread unrest are the Election Commission of India (ECI), its controversial Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise of electoral rolls, and mounting political calls for Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation.

For its part, the poll panel maintains that the SIR exercise is an essential administrative clean-up designed to purge duplicate entries, update legacy rolls, and maintain voter list integrity.

Yet, opposition parties and political groups view the procedural shifts as an opaque hurdle to voter inclusion.

Even as the capital reeled under street-level agitations, an intense parallel confrontation played out inside the Supreme Court over the course of the week.

A bench led by Chief Justice Surya Kant faced urgent petitions challenging the legality of the ECI's administrative moves, specifically zooming in on the controversial modifications made to Form 6 and the core integrity of the multi-member constitutional body.

Petitioners pressed for an immediate interim suspension of CEC Gyanesh Kumar, alleging that crucial electoral roll decisions and procedural shifts had been executed unilaterally without securing the mandatory consensus or approval of fellow election commissioners.

During the hearings, the Apex Court scrutinised the records closely, with the Chief Justice explicitly remarking, "Any modified Form 6 has not been approved by us... when records are produced, we would like to see who has modified what."

While the Bench declined to grant an immediate ex parte interim stay to suspend the CEC-noting that it could not act solely on political



friction or unverified filings-it sternly directed the respondents (Union of India, ECI, and CEC Gyanesh Kumar) to file transparent replies.

The Apex Court warned that if official records ultimately establish that key institutional decisions bypassed collective consensus, those actions would be declared ultra vires.

Beyond the procedural legality of the SIR exercise, the judicial scrutiny directly confronted the executive's heavy-handed lockdown of the capital.

Challenged over blanket metro station closures, train cancellations, and public transit disruptions, CJI Surya Kant invoked the principle of constitutional proportionality, admonishing the authorities that while maintaining law and order is a sovereign duty, "that does not mean you use a hammer to kill a fly."

The Apex Court ordered the state to strike a balance between security measures and the fundamental mobility rights of ordinary citizens.

Now, the week commencing October 12 would be vital as the response of the Union of India, ECI, and CEC Gyanesh Kumar would be analyzed by the Supreme Court.

It would become crystal clear whether key decisions-including the controversial changes to Form 6 and the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise-were taken unilaterally by the CEC or if fellow Election Commissioners Dr. Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Dr. Vivek Joshi were in full concurrence.

If the internal files prove that the CEC acted strictly in accordance with the law and statutory rules, he stands completely vindicated.

However, if the records show that crucial decisions bypassed mandatory multi-member consensus, it could bring a severe setback to his administrative leadership. Any unauthorized actions will be declared ultra vires, creating a massive legal precedent for the Election Commission.

The stakes are equally high for political parties. If the Apex Court validates the ECI's actions, it would deal a heavy blow to the Opposition and groups like the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP), blunting their street momentum.

But if the Court validates their allegations of procedural lapses, it would give them a massive political victory and severely dent public trust in the election management body.

So the need of the hour is the early and urgent adjudication of these burning issues by the Supreme Court. Any delay would add fuel to the fire of the already uncomfortable situation for common citizens in the capital.

What is required is that neither the responding parties should make any procedural delays, nor should those who are agitating in the apex court against the poll body and the CEC, which will give more opportunities for street unrest.

To halt street issues and restore calm, the Supreme Court could consider taking a few decisive steps. Setting a strict, short deadline for all parties to complete their submissions without endless adjournments.

Issuing clear guidelines directing political groups to confine demonstrations to designated areas without paralyzing public transit.

Monitoring police actions to ensure security measures remain fair, balanced, and proportionate.

A swift, authoritative judgment by the apex court is the only way to shift the battlefield back from chaotic city streets into the rule of law, restoring public trust and bringing much-needed relief to the citizens of New Delhi.

A final end to this crisis will ultimately help restore faith in the founding principles of Indian democracy. When constitutional bodies operate with complete transparency and courts step in to safeguard rights, public trust is renewed.

Resolving this conflict through legal due process will prove that no institution is above scrutiny and that citizen voices remain the true bedrock of the republic.

(The Writer is a Senior Journalist covering legal affairs. Views presented are personal).

Order Order

Allahabad HC warns against criminal law misuse in marriages



The Allahabad High Court has warned that routinely turning every distressed or failed marriage into a criminal case could affect the institution of marriage at its core, quashing an FIR alleging dowry harassment, physical assault and attempted strangulation in a case involving a brief period of cohabitation.

A division bench of Justices Chandra Dhari Singh and Tarun Saxena quashed the FIR registered at the Hari Parvat police station in Agra under various provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and the Dowry Prohibition Act, allowing a writ petition filed by Gaurav Jain and his family members.

Emphasising the dangers of converting matrimonial discord intro criminal cases, the court cautioned against the misuse of criminal law in short-lived marriages. According to the facts of the case, the marriage was solemnised on November 12, 2024, and the wife left the matrimonial home on February 3, 2025, after approximately two-and-a-half months of cohabitation. The husband filed a divorce petition on May 3, 2025, following which the FIR was registered on June 30, 2025. The FIR alleged dowry demands and harassment, denial of food, threats, retention of the wife's stridhan and an attempt to strangulate her.

The court noted that no domestic violence complaint, police control room (PCR) call or contemporaneous police intervention concerning the alleged acts had been brought on record from the period of cohabitation. The high court observed that while protecting women from dowry-related violence and cruelty is a statutory and constitutional imperative, the possibility of misuse of criminal law cannot be ignored. It emphasised that matrimonial discord can not automatically be treated as criminality and that criminal proceedings cannot be used as a substitute for adjudication before a matrimonial court.

The high court warned that if every distressed or failed marriage is routinely converted into an FIR and subjected to the coercive machinery of criminal law, the institution of marriage will inevitably be affected at its core. In its judgment dated October 8, the high court clarified that its decision did not adjudicate the merits of the pending matrimonial proceedings.

Both parties remain free to pursue their remedies before the competent matrimonial court. The complainant may also pursue any independent remedy available under the law in respect of a distinct cause of action, subject to statutory requirements. (PTI)

Restores people's faith in justice system: Kapil Sibal after SC's directions to Govt on protests

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Rajya Sabha MP and senior advocate Kapil Sibal on Sunday welcomed the Supreme Court's directions on protests in Delhi, saying the order restored the faith of people and professionals in the country's justice system. "We are deeply grateful to the Supreme Court of India for passing an order that restores the faith of the Indian people, as well as the faith of professionals, in the justice system of this country," Sibal said.

The top court on Sunday directed that people gathering peacefully should not be illegally detained and asked the Centre to ensure that Delhi Metro services function as per their normal schedule and internet services remain uninterrupted, subject to law and order conditions.



A bench of Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana also directed that lawyers, journalists and others should not be impeded from discharging their professional duties.

The court issued notice to the Centre on a plea seeking contempt proceedings against authorities for allegedly violating its October 9 order concerning restrictions on metro and train services in Delhi in view of the protest called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and some student organisations.

The applications before the court alleged that metro services were disrupted, New Delhi and Nizamuddin railway stations remained closed, and a large number of people were subjected to harassment and illegal detention on October 10.

The protest was called against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the functioning of the Election Commission.

Authorities had detained over 7,000 protesters, including CJP founder Abhijit Dipke, opposition leaders and YouTuber Dhruv Rathee, amid a security clampdown to prevent the planned mobilisation at Jantar Mantar on Saturday.



Will hear all parties: SC on contempt pleas against clampdown in Delhi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

In a special sitting, the Supreme Court on Sunday said it will grant hearing to all lawyers while dealing with a plea seeking contempt proceedings against authorities for alleged blatant violation of the court's direction to ensure that "complete prohibition" of metro and trains services should not be implemented in Delhi due to the CJP protest.

A bench of justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana said it will hear all parties and ensure no inconvenience is caused, saying the top court is always at the service of the nation.

"We know you all are aggrieved by what happened yesterday. We are not here to trivialise what happened," the bench said.

The top court is also hearing a habeas petition filed by senior advocate Menaka Guruswamy against the detention of political leaders. The contempt plea, filed by advocate Shailendra Mani Tripathi, has arrayed Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan, Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar and Delhi Metro Rail Corporation chairperson D Thara as respondents.

The petition referred to the top court's October 9 order which was passed while hearing a separate plea against the closure of 57 metro stations and cancellation of trains to Delhi in view of the protest.

The protest call was given by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and some student organisations against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the functioning of the Election Commission.

The government thwarted a planned mass mobilisation at Jantar Mantar on Saturday after an unprecedented security clampdown and the detention of over 7,000 protesters, including CJP leader Abhijit Dipke, several opposition leaders and YouTuber Dhruv Rathee.

Three out of 19 SIR tribunals vacant; EC awaits names from Calcutta HC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

At least three out of 19 apellete tribunals set up in West Bengal to settle disputes related to the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls are vacant amid a massive pendency of appeals, as Election Commission (EC) awaits names from the Calcutta High Court to appoint new persons. EC functionaries said "at least" three tribunals are without heads.

The Calcutta High Court will send names of retired high court judges to the West Bengal chief electoral officers, who in turn will notify their appointments to the three vacant tribunals.



While these tribunals report to Calcutta High Court, EC provides them with secretarial assistance, including staff and digital platform for online hearings.

With local and municipal elections nearing, over 37 lakh voters remain in legal limbo, raising widespread concerns over potential mass disenfranchisement.

Set up on March 21 following Supreme Court directions, the special tribunals were tasked with adjudicating disputes after millions of names were purged or contested during the SIR exercise.

However, according to submissions made in the apex court, there are shortcomings in the system.

Out of 38.3 lakh appeals, 22.2 lakh were filed by deleted voters challenging their exclusion, while 16.1 lakh contested voter inclusions.

Tribunals have resolved only about 1.02 lakh cases -- a completion rate under three per cent.

At the current pace, petitioners informed the Supreme Court that clearing the backlog could take over 12 years.

The opposition has described the SIR exercise as the "biggest hijacking of democracy", accusing the EC of using algorithm-driven processes to disproportionately delete voters' names from electoral rolls, allegedly targeting minority communities and traditional opposition strongholds.

Allahabad HC quashes FIR against police officers, questions special court's order

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Prayagraj

The Allahabad High Court has quashed a "casual" order passed by the Special Judge (SC/ST Act) of Maharajganj, which directed the registration of an FIR against a sub-inspector, a constable, and 20 police officers in a "casual" manner, violating statutory provisions under Section 173(4) of the BNSS dealing with information in cognisable cases.

Quashing the lower court order, Justice Santosh Rai said, "The manner in which the learned Special Judge, SC/ST Act, Maharajganj, has dealt with the application under Section 173(4) of the BNSS is a matter of serious concern. The impugned order reflects a serious lack of appreciation and application of the statutory procedure under the BNSS and the binding principles laid down by the Supreme Court."

"The impugned order reflects a fundamental lack of understanding of the basic principles of criminal law and procedure on the part of the Special Judge, SC/ST Act, Maharajganj," Justice Rai added. As per the facts of the case, an application under Section 173(4) of the BNSS was filed in the court of the Special Judge (SC/ST Act), Maharajganj, by Sheela (29), the wife of Pramod, and Anju (26), the wife of Rajesh, both residents of Basantpur village in Maharajganj district.



They said that both belonged to the Chamar caste, which falls under the Scheduled Caste category.

According to the application, a dispute over land and money existed between the applicants' families and the family of Ramasare.

On the night of June 6, a clash occurred, injuring Rajesh and a man named Pintoo. Later that night, police took away Pintoo, Molai, Suresh and Rahul.

Later that night, sub-inspector Rakesh Kumar Yadav, constable Amit Kumar and about 20 policemen (with no female police officers) forced their entry into the house of the opposite party without a search warrant and outraged their modesty by making caste-based remarks.

Based on the application, the SC/ST court passed an order against the police personnel without examining their comments or the other material on record.

It was contended that the allegations of physical search, indecent behaviour and intimidation were vague, omnibus, uncorroborated and motivated, while the alleged occurrence took place inside a private residential premises and therefore, the essential requirement of "public view" under the SC/ST Act was not prima facie satisfied.

The appellants also contend that the learned court failed to comply with the mandatory procedural safeguards under Sections 175(3) and 175(4) of the BNSS.

After going through the record as well as the arguments raised on behalf of the applicant police personnel, the court in its judgment dated October 9 said, "In view of the foregoing discussion, this court is of the considered opinion that the learned Special Judge, SC/ST Act, Maharajganj, while passing the impugned order, has failed to exercise the jurisdiction vested in him in accordance with the mandatory statutory provisions contained in Sections 175(3) and 175(4) of the BNSS.

The learned court neither undertook the requisite consideration as to whether an inquiry under Section 175(3) was necessary nor recorded "cogent reasons" for dispensing with such an inquiry.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | MONDAY | OCTOBER 12, 2026

The epidemic of Atrial Fibrillation in India: Why endure if we can cure



DR KK TALWAR



Atrial fibrillation (AF) is the most common heart rhythm disorder in the world and the leading cardiac cause of emergency hospitalisations. In India, AF used to be primarily caused by rheumatic heart disease. However, it is now increasingly linked to factors like obesity, hypertension and diabetes, and impacts people across the socioeconomic spectrum.

AF can cause symptoms such as palpitations, breathlessness and chest pain. Even without symptoms, it significantly increases the risk of stroke and heart failure. If untreated, it can shorten life expectancy by 5 to 10 years. It is not a benign condition.

The Role of Catheter Ablation

Historically, AF was treated with medications with even potential toxic side effects in some; it also requires lifelong adherence. Over the past two decades, catheter ablation (thermal ablation) has become the primary treatment for AF in the West.

This procedure, performed by heart rhythm specialists called electrophysiologists, uses catheters inserted through veins in the leg to cauterise abnormal heart impulses causing AF.

Ablation can cure AF, especially in its early stages. When performed by experienced hands, it is extremely safe and effective.

However, the procedure is technically demanding and requires extensive experience for electrophysiologists. While cardiac electrophysiology has made significant progress, it still trails the West, particularly in AF ablation. Limited investment in training contributes to this disparity.

The Promise of Pulsed Field Ablation (PFA)

Over the past few years, Pulsed Field Ablation (PFA) has emerged as a new ablation modality. This procedure has significantly improved speed and safety, leading to its widespread adoption in the USA and Europe. Just last month, PFA launched in India to great excitement among the Indian cardiology community.

While this is a promising development, the prohibitively high cost of each PFA catheter remains a significant barrier for much of India's population. PFA was recently advertised in a national newspaper as a paid advertorial, and I fear such broad direct-to-consumer marketing can confuse patients.

Experienced physicians have long known that every patient needs a personalised approach, which should also align with our goal of providing affordable population-level care.

Leveraging the Expertise of Indian Medical Professionals Abroad

Numerous studies show that traditional thermal ablation can achieve results comparable to PFA when performed by well-trained electrophysiologists.

To bridge this training gap, it is imperative to involve Indian experts who have excelled globally in cardiac electrophysiology.

Dr (Professor) Dhiraj Gupta, an alumnus of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), New Delhi, exemplifies this potential. Based in the United Kingdom, he has pioneered a cost-effective AF ablation technique utilising a single catheter, delivering results comparable to more expensive options like PFA.

Dr Gupta trains local teams in this low-cost ablation technique through pro bono workshops across hospitals in India. This highlights how collaboration with the Indian medical diaspora can build local expertise.

These initiatives not only improve patient outcomes but also promote the adoption of affordable technologies tailored to India's unique healthcare needs. We must ensure similar initiatives continue to be encouraged and developed to facilitate effective skill transfer.

A Call to Action for India's Healthcare System

While technological advancements like PFA are promising, India must prioritise building local training capacity. Encouraging partnerships between domestic hospitals and Indian experts abroad will foster skill transfer and ensure that cutting-edge treatments are accessible to all.

Major Medical institutions, both public and private, should actively seek support from pioneers within the Indian diaspora, such as Professor Gupta, and promote training programmes focused on cost-effective, high-quality care. As the importance of AF increases, a concerted effort to integrate global expertise with local practice will be pivotal in transforming India's cardiac care landscape.

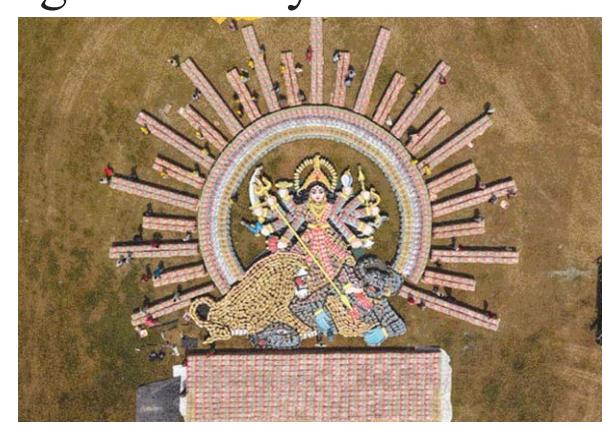
Conclusion

India stands at a crossroads in its fight against atrial fibrillation. By embracing a personalised approach and tapping into the expertise of Indian medical diaspora, we can offer our population not just treatment, but hope-a future where quality cardiac care is both advanced and affordable.

The writer is the chairman of Heart Institute, PSRI Hospital, New Delhi; former professor and head, department of cardiology and director, PGIMER Chandigarh

Adani Cement creates 70-ft aerial tribute to goddess Durga in Madhya Pradesh

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Adani Cement has created a monumental aerial tribute to Maa Durga at its Kymore plant in Madhya Pradesh, using 15,000 cement bags as part of its Navratri and Durga Puja 2026 campaign, Jahan Vishwas, Wahan Shakti. The installation, spread across a 70 ft × 70 ft canvas, represents 750 tonnes of cement and involved 12,600 person-hours of collective effort.

Adani Cement, part of the Adani Portfolio and the world's ninth-largest cement producer, said it is the first and only cement company to create such a large-scale aerial tribute using packed cement bags. The company captured the installation's creation and aerial reveal in a digital film for its digital and social media platforms.

At ground level, the 15,000 cement bags appeared as individual units arranged with precision. As the aerial camera rose, the arrangement revealed the form of Maa Durga, with her crown, eyes, ten arms and flowing form taking shape through the alignment of thousands of cement bags.

The installation brought together the collective efforts of people who transformed individual building materials into a large-scale representation of faith and devotion. The aerial reveal forms the centrepiece of the campaign's digital film, which captures the process of creating the artwork and its unveiling from above.

The campaign, titled Jahan Vishwas, Wahan Shakti, brings together two key brand ideas associated with Adani Cement's portfolio. Shakti reflects Ambuja Cements' promise of strength, while Vishwas draws on ACC's legacy of trust spanning more than nine decades.

Through the image of Maa Durga, revered as an embodiment of strength and protection, the campaign combines these two ideas in a tribute to faith, tradition and collective endeavour. The initiative uses cement bags, a material associated with building homes and infrastructure, to convey the message that trust and strength together can create something larger than the sum of its parts.

The digital film begins at ground level, showing hands at work, cement bags being moved into position, and the installation gradually taking shape. As the camera moves upward, the arrangement becomes clearer, eventually revealing the complete image of Maa Durga. The shift in perspective highlights the collective effort behind the installation and reinforces the campaign's central message of Jahan Vishwas, Wahan Shakti.

The campaign also celebrates the people of Kymore, home to ACC's cement plant established in 1923.

The town has a long-standing tradition of Ram Leela celebrations, making it a significant location for an initiative centred on faith, cultural heritage and community participation.

With the installation, Adani Cement has used an unconventional arrangement of cement bags to bring together its brands' core values of trust and strength while marking the festive season of Navratri and Durga Puja 2026.

Adani Defence & Aerospace wins SIDM Champion Award 2026 for excellence in defence export

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Adani Defence & Aerospace has won the Society of Indian Defence Manufacturers (SIDM) Champion Award 2026 for Export Performance in Defence and Aerospace at the organisation's eighth annual session in New Delhi on October 9.

The company manufactures small-calibre ammunition for defence and law enforcement customers in international markets. Its manufacturing complex in Kanpur, Uttar Pradesh, has an annual production capacity of 300 million rounds and produces North Atlantic Treaty Organisation (NATO)-standard ammunition, supporting the Government of India's "Aatmanirbhar Bharat" initiative.

Honourable Defence Minister Shri Rajnath Singh presented the award in the presence of Defence Secretary Mr Rajesh Kumar Singh and Director General (Acquisition) Mr A. Anbarasu. Fifteen awards recognised achievements in technology development, product innovation, design, import substitution, manufacturing excellence and exports.

Addressing the session, Shri Singh called for greater private sector participation in defence production, increased investment in research and development, and expanded manufacturing capacity to meet the country's defence requirements.

Ashish Rajvanshi, Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Adani Defence & Aerospace, said, "We are proud to see our efforts in building India's defence manufacturing capabilities recognised. Our focus is on making high-quality products in India and taking them to customers across global markets. We will continue to invest in technology and indigenous manufacturing to meet the evolving needs of defence and security customers."

The latest recognition follows a separate SIDM Champion Award presented to Adani Defence & Aerospace's Kanpur Ammunition Complex in 2025 for design, manufacturing and testing excellence.

The Kanpur facility uses automated manufacturing, artificial intelligence (AI)-enabled quality inspection, real-time data analytics and digital monitoring across the production process. Its digital shopfloor eliminates manual handling of hazardous materials.

The unit also has 100 per cent digital traceability across the manufacturing value chain, supported by digital security systems.

The complex houses a ballistics testing range equipped with an Electronic Pressure, Velocity and Action Time (EPVAT) system. The National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories (NABL), India's apex accreditation body for testing and calibration laboratories, has accredited the range.

Adani's Kutch Copper plans 115 MW renewable energy integration, targets lower emissions

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Adani Enterprises Ltd's Kutch Copper Ltd plans to integrate 115 megawatts of renewable energy into its operations to reduce emissions, conserve water, and improve resource efficiency at its Mundra, Gujarat, copper refinery.

The company currently operates a copper smelter with a capacity of 5,00,000 tonnes per annum.

It plans to expand it to 1 million tonnes, which, according to the company, would make it the world's largest single-location custom smelter.

In its maiden sustainability report, Kutch Copper outlined plans to embed environmental, social and governance considerations into its operations as demand for the metal grows on the back of energy transition investments, electric mobility, power transmission and industrial expansion.

"A key element of our sustainability strategy is the planned integration of 115 megawatts of renewable energy, a significant step towards reducing the carbon footprint of our operations and advancing long-term decarbonisation goals," the company said.

Copper is a key material for clean energy technologies and electrification, placing the metal at the centre of efforts to cut carbon emissions. Kutch Copper said it aims to scale up production while integrating sustainability considerations into business decisions, operations and stakeholder engagement.

The company said it operates on nearly 100 per cent desalinated water and follows a zero-liquid-discharge approach to reduce dependence on freshwater and improve water conservation.

"We are currently treating 99.8 per cent of sulphur emissions, reflecting our commitment to adopting global standards in environmental stewardship and pollution control by leveraging advanced environmental technologies," Kutch Copper said in the report.

Beyond its manufacturing operations, the company said it is investing in community programmes focused on healthcare, education, livelihoods and social development.

The company said the Adani Group has committed USD 1.2 billion to the project. The group sees the domestic copper industry as playing a key role in India's ambition to achieve carbon neutrality by 2070, supported by investment in green infrastructure and environmental management.

NTPC invites EoI from commercial, industrial entities to invest in co-generation projects

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



NTPC Limited, India's largest integrated power utility, has invited Expressions of Interest (EOI) from Commercial and Industrial (C&I) entities interested in taking 26 per cent equity in co-generation projects.

The initiative aims to explore opportunities to develop co-generation facilities to meet industrial requirements for steam and electricity, along with integrated power supply solutions based on coal, renewable energy and Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS), the power PSU said in a statement.

With industries increasingly focusing on energy security, cost optimisation and sustainability, co-generation offers an opportunity to enhance overall energy efficiency by producing steam and electricity through an integrated system.

The proposed initiative seeks to address the diverse requirements of industries with reliable, economical and sustainable energy solutions through long-term power supply arrangements.

It reflects NTPC's commitment to expanding its energy solutions portfolio and strengthening partnerships with industries.

By leveraging its expertise in power generation and exploring innovative energy supply models, NTPC aims to support industrial growth while contributing to energy efficiency, sustainability and energy transition objectives.

NTPC Limited is India's largest integrated power utility with an installed capacity of over 91 GW, with another 35+ GW under construction. The company has set a target to reach 149 GW of total capacity by 2032, including 60 GW from renewable energy sources. This includes a balanced mix of thermal, hydro, solar, and wind power plants, ensuring the supply of reliable, affordable, and sustainable electricity to the country.

Along with power generation, NTPC has ventured into various new business areas, including e-mobility, storage, waste-to-energy, nuclear power, and green hydrogen solutions.

RBI's rupee defence may drain banking liquidity and ease currency pressure

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai



The Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) measures to curb rupee volatility could ease near-term depreciation pressure and help withdraw surplus liquidity from the banking system, according to research reports.

The measures, including a dedicated dollar window for oil marketing companies through designated banks and higher costs for certain foreign exchange hedging transactions, are expected to reduce dollar demand in the spot market and curb speculative positions against the rupee.

"The immediate reaction on INR is expected to be very favourable-likely move of USDINR towards sub-95 cannot be ruled out. Forward premia is likely to soften as OMCs and other importer hedging gets contained," Kotak Mahindra Bank said in its report, while cautioning that the global environment remains uncertain.

IDFC FIRST Bank said the measures were expected to result in a near-term reduction in USD/INR and lower forward premiums, but added that global factors and balance-of-payments dynamics would determine the currency's medium-term trajectory.

The RBI, in its October 10 circulars, barred authorised dealers from allowing users to rebook cancelled rupee-linked foreign exchange derivative contracts, while continuing to permit rollovers on maturity subject to existing regulations. It also reduced the threshold for undertaking foreign exchange derivative transactions without establishing an underlying exposure to USD 5 million from USD 100 million, across authorised dealers and recognised stock exchanges.

The central bank also introduced a Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve (FERR), requiring authorised dealers to maintain with the RBI, in cash, 20 per cent of the rupee equivalent of the notional amount of each rupee-linked foreign exchange derivative contract exceeding USD 2 million, where the transaction is undertaken to hedge current account exposures involving the purchase of foreign currency against the rupee. The RBI said the measures were aimed at strengthening market discipline and ensuring appropriate risk management while maintaining an orderly and transparent foreign exchange market.

Gold, silver range-bound; weak rupee lends support: Analysts

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Gold and silver prices are likely to trade in a range with a slightly positive bias next week as rupee weakness cushions domestic bullion against global fluctuations, while inflation data will shape investors' sentiment, analysts said.

Traders will track inflation readings from India, China and the US. Trade data from Beijing and speeches from Federal Reserve officials will provide cues on whether the US central bank will deliver another rate hike in October or defer it to December, they added.

"The outlook remains range-bound with a mildly positive undertone, as rupee weakness provides a cushion against global price fluctuations," Jateen Trivedi, VP Research Analyst — Commodity and Currency, LKP Securities, said.

On the Multi Commodity Exchange (MCX), gold futures for December delivery gained ₹1,109, or nearly 1 per cent, last week to settle at ₹1.51 lakh per 10 grams. Silver, however, ended marginally lower by ₹122 to ₹2.25 lakh per kilogram.

MCX gold's recovery was supported by a softer US dollar, easing bond yields and improved geopolitical sentiment. A decline in crude oil prices on Friday also eased immediate inflation concerns, and weakness in the rupee provided additional support to domestic bullion, Trivedi said.

"A weaker rupee increases the landed cost of imported bullion, helping MCX gold remain supported even when international prices face pressure. This currency impact could continue to cushion domestic prices against any moderate correction in Comex gold," he added.

In overseas markets, Comex gold futures for December delivery gained 54, or 1.3 per cent, last week to close at USD 4,216.3 per ounce, while silver rose over 1 per cent to USD 61.05 per ounce.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | MONDAY | OCTOBER 12, 2026
BHARAT KI SOCH
भारत की सोच
BHARAT KI SOCH

When Heritage Finds a New Stage: Gaudiya Nritya and the Creative Economy



ATANU CHAKRABARTY
FORMER ECONOMIC AFFAIRS SECRETARY, MOF, GOI



MANASHI GHOSH
JUNIOR RESEARCH FELLOW, BHARAT KI SOCH

Gaudiya Nritya is a reconstructed classical dance tradition of Bengal whose historical evidence can be explored through literature, *Natyasastra*, manuscripts and sculpture. It is thus important to examine how this rich heritage can contribute to Bengal's creative economy and strengthen India's cultural soft power.

The word *Gaudiya* offers an important point to understand the cultural geography of the tradition. This *Nritya* is now associated with Bengal region. *Gaud* region originally represented the region west and south of Padma river and centred around present day Malda and Murshidabad districts. However, on account of conquests by Sena and Pala dynasties this word along with "Vanga/Banga" also reflected the entire region including the area east of Padma river that is now Bangladesh. The term appears in Sanskrit literary traditions, inscriptions and later cultural usage. Bengal's rulers were at different points described by titles such as *Gaudadhipati* and *Gaudeshvara* which reflecting the continuing association of the region with Gauda. The Bengal of earlier centuries, however, cannot be mapped neatly onto the political boundaries of the present. Its cultural landscape extended across areas that now form parts of India and Bangladesh. Rivers, pilgrimage routes, temples, monastic centres, royal courts and settlements connected these regions, allowing Sanskrit, Bengali and other vernacular traditions to develop in constant interaction. This Pan-Bengal character is particularly important when considering the history of *Gaudiya Nritya*. Unlike traditions preserved through a single, continuous textual or institutional lineage, its evidence is dispersed across different kinds of sources. Literary works, Sanskrit treatises on dance and music, architectural remains, sculptures, paintings and living performance traditions each preserve fragments of a larger cultural memory. The reconstruction of *Gaudiya Nritya* therefore, involves reading these sources alongside one another rather than searching for a single definitive manuscript that might explain the tradition in its entirety.

The literary evidence offers some of the earliest clues. The source connects the pre-Pala theatrical tradition described in the *Natyasastra* with regional forms and identifies *Oidramagadhi* as a possible ancient antecedent of *Gaudiya*. Later literary traditions provide a richer portrait of dance as a social and aesthetic practice. The *Caryapada* for example refers to women associated with the *Siddhacharyas* who were accomplished in singing and dancing. Moreover, the Sena period adds another layer when literature, music and the performing arts flourished together. This dance form is deeply rooted in the *Natyashastra's basics of 'Bhav", 'Mudra 'and 'Abhinaya'.* Religious underpinning came from *Shakta* and *Shaiva* traditions.

Subsequently, when Jayadeva composed the *Gitagovinda*, a work that brought poetry and music into close relationship with dance and performance. Jayadeva was known for his *Gitikavya* while Padmavati was associated was a dancer. Chaitanya, through his Bhakti cult took it to Assam and Manipur. Those region also derived their dance forms. Vaishnavite traditions provided form and musical basis. So, we have *Dashavatar,* Raslila of Radha-Krisna of Vaishnav tradition and Mahisasura-Mardini that reflect *Shakta* tradition. This eclectic mix reflects a cultural world in which poetry, music and dance were not separate arts but part of a shared aesthetic tradition. *Padavali Kirtan* and *Khol* (Mridangam) became an integral part of the performance of this dance. Percussion artists playing '*Kartal*' broadened the musical base of this art form.

As, mentioned *earlier*, the four familiar abhinayas are *angika* (bodily expression), *vacika* (speech or musical expression), *aharya* (costume and visual representation) and *sattvika* (inner emotional expression). The textual sources associated with the tradition further elaborate its aesthetic and technical terminology such as the *Sangita Damodara* discusses several fundamental aspects of performance including *bhramari, padaveda, karana, sthanaka* and various *rasa*. The *Sri-Hasta-Muktavali* which is an important theoretical source that offers an extensive treatment of hand gestures or *mudra* and their expressive functions.

There are literary works, such as *Mangalakavya* tradition provides yet another window. In the *Manasamangalakavya*, that suggest that dance was closely intertwined into the religious imagination and social life of Bengal, rather than being restricted merely royal courts or formal performances.

The sculptural record provides another importance. Archaeological sites such as *Paharpur* and *Mahasthangarh* preserve sculptural representations like various dance postures, gestures and expressive forms. Particularly draws attention to image of *Natesvara, Siva* as the Lord of Dance, including a tenth-century image associated with the Pala period in present day Bangladesh. The principle behind such evidence is beautifully expressed in the *Visnudharmottara Purana: "Chitrasutram na janati..."* this sloka help to understand the relationship between the knowledge of dance and the interpretation of painting and iconography, reflecting the close interconnection of the visual and performing arts. In this context *Gaudiya Nritya* is not simply a sequence of movement. It is a cultural grammar assembled from several archives.

Subsequent to conquest of this region by Bakhtiyar Khalji, destruction of temples and literary traditions took place at a large scale. Multiple invasions, and subsequent neglect of this tradition in *'Bhadra-lok'* circle led to decline of this classical dance form.

Yet cultural traditions may become marginalised but their historical traces continue to survive. Social attitudes, impacted by external invasions and subsequent neglect of our traditions as well as partition that caused vivisection of what was known as "Gaud Pradesh or Banga" contributed to the marginalisation of dancers, that displaced dance from mainstream cultural life.

Although the twentieth century witnessed the revival and institutionalisation of several Indian classical dance traditions, Bengal's own classical dance heritage remained comparatively obscured and received limited recognition within the broader national narrative of Indian classical dance. The turning point came through renewed questioning. During an excursion to the Ananta Basudev temple, Prof. Mahua Mukherjee encountered sculptures of dancers and asked a deceptively simple question: if Bengal had no classical dance tradition of its own the why were these dancing figures there? That question led to decades of investigation. Mukherjee drew upon Bengali and Sanskrit literature, classical texts, sculptures, paintings and rural dance practices in an attempt to reconstruct the lost vocabulary. In 1994, following extensive research, the dance form presented as *Gaudiya Nritya.* Its contemporary form is therefore understood neither as an unbroken survival from antiquity nor as a tradition detached from its historical foundations. Rather, it represents a process of reconstruction grounded in textual, visual, and performative evidence, and sustained through continuing research, interpretation and practice.

The priority now must be to move from revival to institutional sustainability like establishing a dedicated ecosystem for *Gaudiya Nritya*, supporting *Guru Shishya* training, youth engagement, digital archiving, research, festivals and cultural tourism. Durga Puja can serve as a national and global platform. Such policy support can create sustainable livelihoods for artists and scholars while strengthening Bengal's tourism economy and India's cultural soft power.

Fable with Moral

The Pot with a Crack



An elderly water bearer had two large pots, each hung on the ends of a pole which he carried across his neck. One of the pots had a crack in it, while the other pot was perfect. At the end of the long walk from the stream to the master's house, the cracked pot arrived only half full. The perfect pot was proud of its accomplishments. But the poor cracked pot was ashamed of its own imperfection as it was able to accomplish only half of what it was made to do.

After two years of what it perceived to be a bitter failure, it spoke to the water bearer one day. "I am ashamed of myself and I want to apologize to you."

"Why?" asked the bearer.

"I have been able to deliver only half my load because this crack in my side causes water to leak out all the way back to your master's house. Because of my flaws, you don't get full value from your efforts," the pot said.

The water bearer felt sorry for the old cracked pot and said with compassion, "As we return to the master's house, I want you to notice the beautiful flowers along the path." As they went up the hill, the cracked pot observed the beautiful wild flowers on the side of the path feeling a bit happy. But at the end of the trail, it still felt bad because it had leaked out half its load and hence, again apologized to the bearer.

The bearer said to the pot, "Did you notice that there were flowers only on your side of the path, but not on the other pot's side? That's because I have always known about your flaw and I used it to my advantage. I planted flower seeds on your side of the path and every day while we walk back from the stream, you've watered them. For two years I have been able to pick these beautiful flowers to decorate my master's table. Without you being just the way you are, he would not have this beauty to grace his house."

MORAL- Limitations should not dishearten you from persevering!

Did you know?



Indian textiles enjoyed extraordinary demand across Europe, Southeast Asia, Central Asia and the Middle East. By around 1500, Indian cotton cloth was central to commercial networks extending from Japan and Indonesia in the east to Ethiopia, Egypt and West Africa in the west. Major centres of production included Gujarat, the Coromandel Coast and, later, Bengal. European travellers were struck by the refinement of these fabrics. Writing in 1598, the Dutch traveller Jan Huygen van Linschoten noted that Indian cotton cloth was highly prized in Asian markets and, in some contexts, valued even above silk.

In parts of Africa, Indian cloth functioned as a medium of exchange, with "Guinea cloth" used in transactions involving commodities such as gum and ivory. In Southeast Asia, Indian textiles were widely accepted in commercial dealings, while in Europe they helped shape an emerging culture of fashion and consumption.

India's real advantage lay in technical expertise. Indian dyers had mastered sophisticated mordant-dyeing techniques and durable red dyes that European producers struggled to reproduce despite access to similar raw materials. In this sense, India helped define the benchmark against which Europe's own cotton industry developed.

Wisdom Word Search

A	G	N	P	A	N	A	M	O	P	K	L	S
N	E	A	L	I	K	O	J	A	A	A	P	C
G	L	I	Q	L	O	I	V	E	N	P	E	H
A	U	A	T	A	O	L	A	I	I	K	R	E
D	P	M	D	H	T	A	A	E	K	P	U	L
I	A	J	S	S	T	Q	N	N	K	O	J	A
M	O	T	V	E	A	G	G	A	K	T	K	V
A	J	M	W	A	L	I	A	S	A	L	U	S
L	K	Q	N	G	R	H	L	K	R	L	Y	E
T	P	O	R	U	L	A	U	O	A	D	N	L
I	W	J	S	H	N	S	V	B	N	U	G	G
S	C	H	A	N	T	A	O	N	O	I	W	X

WORDS TO FIND
Angadi, Chanta, Chelav, Koottal, Panam, Panikkaran, Porul, Perukku, Vaangal, Varav

THE WISDOM LEXICON

ANGADI - marketplace, bazaar
CHANTA - market
CHELAV - expenditure, cost
KOOTTAL - addition, accumulation
PANAM - money, cash
PANIKKARAN - worker
PERUKKU - increase, growth
PORUL - wealth, material resource, economic substance
VAANGAL - buying, purchase
VARAV - income, receipts; incoming

Note: These terms come from Malayalam, one of India's 22 Scheduled Languages.

Marvels of India

HARAPPAN-MESOPOTAMIAN TRADE

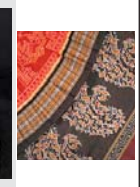


Commerce
Sumerian writings from ancient Mesopotamia (the earliest known writing systems) mention the Sindhu-Saraswati, or Harappan civilisation, as *Meluhha*. The first ruler of the Akkadian Empire, Sargon of Akkad, recorded that ships from *Meluhha, Magan* and *Dilmun* (all Bronze Age civilisations) docked at his capital. Harappa-type carnelian beads adorned Queen Puabi's cloak (an elaborate garment made of precious and semi-precious stones) found at the Royal Cemetery at Ur (a major city-state of ancient Mesopotamia). Harappan seals and ivory also reached Central Asian sites such as Altyn Depe and Gonur Depe (two major Bronze Age archaeological sites in Turkmenistan), thereby evidencing a vast commercial exchange.

Economy
Mesopotamian elites prized Harappan carnelian and lapis as prestige goods. Ur's merchants, acting like venture capitalists, imported copper, timber and pearls by sea. A famed American anthropologist, Gregory Possehl, observes that this trade shaped the cultural landscape in the Greater Harappan Valley.

Standardisation
Researchers found stamped seals, some bearing Harappan script, in Bahrain alongside stone weights matching Harappan units. This suggests that merchants relied on shared measurement and authentication. Together, these mark one of the Indian subcontinent's earliest documented international commercial networks.

QUIZ — Economy, Commerce & Finance

	Questions	Option A	Option B	Option C	Option D
1	Which of these is not a GI-tagged product from Odisha?				
2	Which of them was a powerful merchant guild that dominated maritime and overland trade across South India during the early medieval period?	Mahattara	Nigamas	Ayyavole	Pugas
3	Which commodities was ancient Kalinga famous for exporting across the Indian subcontinent?	Pearls & diamonds	Spices & teak wood	Cotton textiles & war elephants	Iron weapons & copperware
4	Which of these historical sites is most renowned for its bangle factory?	Kalibangan	Alamgirpur	Daimabad	Mand

Answers: 1 - B, 2 - C, 3 - C, 4 - A

AESOP'S FABLES

The Fox and the Stork



One day, the Fox decided to amuse himself by playing a trick on the Stork, whose unusual appearance he often made fun of. The Stork gladly accepted the invitation and arrived with a good appetite. "You must come and dine with me today"



For dinner, however, the Fox served soup in a very shallow dish. The Fox had no difficulty eating it. He quickly lapped up the soup with his tongue. But the Stork, with his long, narrow bill, could hardly eat anything at all. He could only wet the tip of his bill while the Fox enjoyed the meal.



The Fox mischievously asked whether the Stork liked the soup. The Stork did not become angry.



When the Fox arrived, he smelled a delicious fish dinner and eagerly looked forward to eating it. But the Stork had served the food in a tall jar with a very narrow neck.



The Stork easily put his long bill inside the jar and ate his fill. The Fox, however, could not reach the food. All he could do was lick around the outside of the jar and smell the delicious meal.

The Fox became angry. The Stork calmly reminded him that he was only receiving the same sort of treatment that he himself had given his guest.



MORAL OF THE STORY: As you treat others, so you will be treated.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | MONDAY | OCTOBER 12, 2026

World leaders condemn attack on Riyadh airport

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Washington/Dubai

Leaders and senior officials from across the world have condemned the deadly attack on Saudi Arabia's King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh that killed 12 people and injured more than 300.

US President Donald Trump said on Saturday that Washington was considering joining Saudi strikes against Yemen's Houthi rebels, according to US media reports. United Nations Secretary-General Antonio Guterres, European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio and Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney were among those who denounced the attack, while Pakistan, Qatar, Palestine, Jordan and Malaysia expressed solidarity with Saudi Arabia.

Saturday's strike, which Saudi Arabia blamed on the Iran-backed Houthis, was the latest in a series of attacks on the kingdom's infrastructure amid an intensifying conflict in Yemen. Saudi airports have come under several attacks this month, including strikes on Riyadh and Abha.

The latest violence comes against the backdrop of the wider war involving Iran and its regional adversaries, raising concerns about further instability across the region.

Von der Leyen said the attack marked a "dangerous escalation", expressed solidarity with Saudi Arabia and its people, and offered condolences to the victims and their families. She said attacks by Iran's proxies were pushing the region into a spiral of violence and destabilising crucial global transport and energy nodes.

The EU chief described the attacks on civilians as murderous and said they must stop immediately.

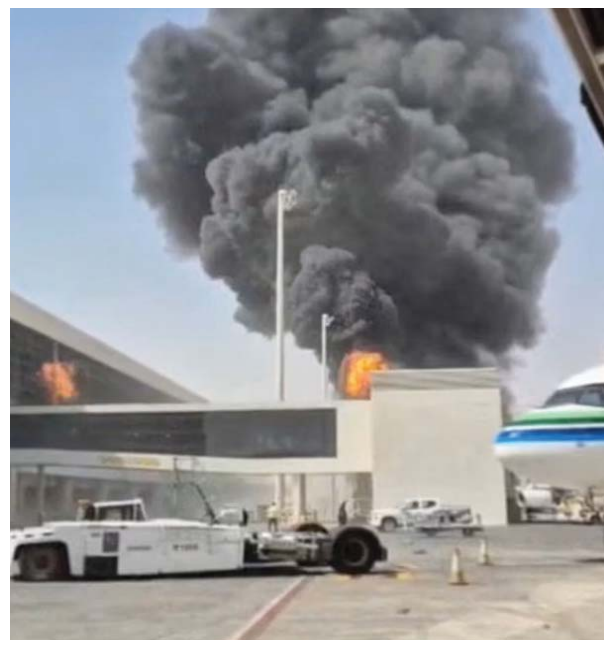
Guterres on Sunday said he was "deeply shocked" by the attack and strongly condemned it. "Attacks on civilians and civilian infrastructure are a violation of international law. These attacks must cease immediately," the UN chief said in a post on X. Trump said on Saturday he was considering whether the United States should join Saudi strikes against the Houthis. "We may. We're going to look at it. We just found out about the recent attack. So we'll make a decision. We move very quickly," he told reporters, according to the AP news agency.

Rubio said the US strongly condemned the recent attacks on Saudi Arabia, including the strike on Riyadh's airport that killed an American citizen.

"These reprehensible attacks must stop," he said, adding that Washington stood with Saudi Arabia and extending condolences to the victims and their families.

Carney described the Houthi attacks as "abhorrent", saying there could be no justification for attacks on civilian infrastructure or the deliberate targeting of innocent people.

"Canada condemns these reckless acts of violence in the strongest possible



terms," he said in a social media post, extending condolences to the families of those killed and wishing a full recovery to the injured.

Hans Grundberg, the UN special envoy for Yemen, described strikes on civilian airports in Saudi Arabia as a "grave escalation", warning that they threatened regional security and complicated efforts to achieve peace.

Malaysia PM Anwar Ibrahim said he unequivocally denounced the attack, which had taken innocent lives and left hundreds injured. He extended condolences to the families of those killed and wished the injured a swift recovery.

"There can be no justification for attacks against civilians and civilian infrastructure," Anwar said, adding that such attacks could deepen the suffering caused by the conflict and spread it to places that should remain beyond its reach.

Malaysia stood in solidarity with Saudi Arabia and hoped diplomacy and reason would prevail before the conflict widened further, he said. Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif also strongly condemned the attack, calling it a flagrant violation of international law and a threat to regional peace and stability.

Sharif reaffirmed Islamabad's support for Saudi Arabia's sovereignty, territorial integrity and security, citing the two countries' ties and the Makkah Joint Defence Agreement signed in August. The agreement, signed by Saudi Arabia, Pakistan and Turkiye on August 7, stipulates that an armed attack against any one of the three countries shall be regarded as an attack against all three.

Qatar's Foreign Ministry condemned the attack as a grave violation of Saudi Arabia's sovereignty and a direct threat to regional security, civilian safety and air navigation. It expressed solidarity with Riyadh and said Saudi Arabia's security was integral to Qatar's own security and that of the Gulf Cooperation Council states. Palestine's Foreign Ministry condemned the attack and expressed solidarity with Saudi Arabia. It offered condolences to the families of those killed and wished the injured a speedy recovery.

Egypt also condemned the attacks, describing them as a violation of international law and expressing concern over the threat to civilian safety.

India on Sunday also strongly condemned repeated attacks on Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport over the past few days, including Saturday's strike.

CHILDREN AMONG 109 DEAD AFTER BOAT CAPSISES OFF DJIBOUTI, SAYS IOM



ASSOCIATED PRESS
Geneva

At least 109 migrants, including 15 children, have died after a boat with 305 on board capsized off the coast of Djibouti in east Africa, the International Organisation for Migration (IOM) said on Sunday.

The boat was travelling from Djibouti to Yemen when it capsized on Thursday night or Friday morning, according to the IOM. 52 men, 42 women and 15 children died. More than 80 people survived the accident, while at least 116 others remain missing.

Tens of thousands of migrants from the Horn of Africa travel through Djibouti and across the Bab el-Mandeb Strait towards the Gulf countries, in search of safety and economic opportunities, said the IOM in its statement. That movement has continued despite violence in Yemen.

"This is a devastating loss of life," said Alexandre Coissac, IOM Chief of Mission in Djibouti. "This tragedy is a stark reminder of the dangers faced by migrants along this migration corridor as they seek economic opportunities."

India rejects UN concerns on Delhi protest

ASHOKE RAJ
New Delhi

India has rejected concerns raised by the United Nations human rights office over protests in New Delhi, describing the remarks as "misplaced" and reiterating that the Constitution guarantees citizens the right to peaceful assembly, subject to reasonable restrictions to maintain public order. Meanwhile, Bangladesh's National Citizen Party (NCP) has expressed solidarity with demonstrations led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) over alleged irregularities in the revision of electoral rolls.

The controversy centres on protests against the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and demands for the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. Protesters have raised concerns about electoral transparency and the functioning of the Election Commission, prompting heightened security arrangements in the national capital.

In its response to the UN human rights office, the Indian Embassy maintained that peaceful assembly is a constitutional right but noted that reasonable restrictions may be imposed when necessary to protect public order.

The exchange has renewed debate over the balance between civil liberties, democratic accountability and the responsibilities of authorities in managing public demonstrations. Security personnel were deployed around Jantar Mantar Road as



Protestors raise slogans amid continued demonstration calls by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar in Connaught Place area in New Delhi on Sunday PTI

authorities monitored the situation following the protest call. The handling of demonstrations, including reported detentions of protesters, organisers and journalists, has also attracted criticism from political groups and raised questions about restrictions on public assembly and internet access.

Bangladesh's NCP convener Nahid Islam voiced support for the demonstrators in a statement shared on X from Dhaka.

He argued that democratic forces in India deserved transparent answers regarding electoral integrity and institutional independence, warning that detentions and restrictions on public gatherings threatened fundamental freedoms. Islam connected the protests to Bangladesh's July 2024 student-led uprising, which began over government recruitment quotas before expanding into a nationwide movement against former Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina's 15-year rule. Hasina left power in August 2024. Citing a United Nations estimate that up to 1,400 people were killed during the uprising and its suppression, Islam highlighted the consequences of confronting authoritarian rule.

He also acknowledged support from Indian students, writers and independent voices during Bangladesh's protests, drawing parallels with movements such as the Shaheen Bagh demonstrations against the Citizenship Amendment Act and student activism at Jawaharlal Nehru University and Jadavpur University. He praised women's participation in demonstrations in both countries.

Calling for equality, social justice and communal harmony, Islam criticised religious supremacy and authoritarianism, arguing that democratic societies must protect minorities and the right to dissent irrespective of religion, caste, gender or social background.

Japan honours Hyderabad-based Ikebanist Nirmala Agarwal for promoting India-Japan friendship

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Hyderabad

The Consulate-General of Japan has honoured Hyderabad-based Ikebanist Nirmala Agarwal with the Consul General's Commendation Award for her contribution to promoting friendship and mutual understanding between Japan and India.

The award was presented by the Consulate-General at a ceremony held at Cyber Garden in Hyderabad on Sunday, October 11, 2026.

A practitioner of Ikebana, the traditional Japanese art of flower arrangement, Agarwal began her journey with the art in 2000. She



holds the Associate First Master degree from Japan's Ohara School of Ikebana and has been associated with the art form for over two decades.

She is currently serving her second term as president of the Hyderabad Chapter of the Ohara School of Ikebana. During her tenure, the chapter hosted the school's Headmaster in Hyderabad for a demonstration and workshop for the first time and organised its first Pan-India Ikebana Seminar in the city.

Agarwal has participated in several regional and international Ikebana conferences and conducted demonstrations and workshops for schools, educational institutions and women's organisations, helping introduce the Japanese art form to wider audiences.

She views Ikebana as more than flower arrangement, describing it as an artistic discipline that expresses emotions and ideas through the thoughtful placement of flowers, foliage and branches. Its emphasis on harmony, balance, proportion, minimalism and simplicity reflects aesthetic values shared by Japanese and Indian cultures.

Pakistan Opposition slams emergency in KPK

M ZULQERNAIN
Lahore

Pakistan opposition parties and a lawyers' body on Sunday strongly condemned the imposition of emergency and governor's rule in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, calling it a "grave political mistake" which the people will never accept.

The Shehbaz Sharif government on Sunday imposed an emergency and governor's rule in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KPK) following the president's approval.

The Prime Minister's Office said in a statement that the cabinet members reviewed the situation and took note of the "provincial government's deliberate disengagement from the fight against terrorism". President Asif Ali Zardari issued a proclamation under



Police guard near Khyber Pakhtunkhwa on Sunday

Articles 232(1) and 234(1) of the Constitution, citing rising terrorist attacks and a breakdown of constitutional machinery in the northwestern province, according to the presidential declaration.

The members proposed, given the "gravity" of the situation, that the PM advise the president to exercise "his constitutional authority and impose an emergency in the province under Articles 232 and 234 of the Constitution".

An emergency allows Pakistan's federal government to assume key executive and legislative powers in a province during a security crisis or breakdown of constitutional governance. Under the proclamation, the chief minister, provincial ministers, advisers, special assistants and advocate general will immediately vacate their offices.

The move comes amid an ongoing protest march led by KPK Chief Minister Sohail Afridi, who is pressing for jailed former prime minister Imran Khan's release and access to medical treatment for him. The march began in Lakki Marwat on October 4 and has passed through several districts of the province.

Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf (PTI) chairman Barrister Gohar Khan said, "We completely reject this action. The mandate of the people of the KP is their constitutional and legal right. Peace cannot be established nor stability brought by ignoring this mandate, weakening provincial autonomy and creating conflict between the federation and the province."

He said terrorism can only be combated through national unity and a joint strategy.

PTI senior leader and former federal minister Moonis Elahi lambasted the federal government, saying provincial autonomy is no charity; it is a constitutional right.

"The people's mandate is no one's fiefdom to be snatched away at will. There can be no compromise on the supremacy of the Constitution, the people's right to governance, and provincial autonomy," Elahi said. (*PTI*)

Kyiv rejects Trump's call for new president

SUSIE BLANN/
ELISE MORTON
Kyiv

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Sunday that only Russia was responsible for the war in his country. He said Ukraine would halt strikes on Russian oil refineries if Moscow stopped hitting Ukraine's energy grid, after US President Donald Trump blamed him for high diesel prices and said it was time for Ukraine to get a new leader.

The exchange came as Kyiv pressed its campaign against infrastructure deep inside Russia, with a drone attack on Sunday shutting down a data centre run by Russian technology giant Yandex, the third strike on the company's facilities in four days.

Russia and Ukraine are locked in a long-range aerial war while their armies remain largely deadlocked on the front line, more than 4.5 years since Moscow's full-scale invasion.

"Ukraine will be ready to stop striking Russian oil refineries if Russia stops striking our energy infrastructure," Zelenskyy wrote



on X. "It is possible to stop strikes on energy infrastructure as early as today, but Putin does not want to do so," he said, adding that any de-escalation must be reciprocal and backed by real guarantees.

Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha pushed back on Trump's comments, writing on X late Saturday that Zelenskyy was leading the country through a war for its independence. "He has the support of the Ukrainian people, and they have the right to decide. Statements from abroad only confirm that he is doing his job well," Sybiha wrote.

Trump said Saturday it was time for Ukraine to get a new president, suggesting Zelenskyy has not done enough to end the war and blaming him for high diesel prices in the US.

"I suggest they get a new leader who can make a deal because he could have made many deals and for some reason he never does," Trump said.

The US president, who on Friday struck a deal with Russian President Vladimir Putin to buy diesel from Russia in an attempt to address high fuel prices ahead of the US midterm elections, has been urging Zelenskyy for weeks to stop strikes on Russian energy infrastructure.

He has sought to blame record US diesel prices on Ukraine rather than the US-led war in Iran, which has driven up world energy prices. Ukrainian and European officials reacted to the diesel deal with dismay, saying it will help pay for Russia's war effort.

A Ukrainian drone attack shut down a data centre run by Russian technology giant Yandex, the company said Sunday, the third strike on its facilities in four days as Kyiv widens its campaign against infrastructure deep inside Russia.

The attack on the data centre in the city of Vladimir, east of Moscow, caused outages across Yandex's services, leaving users in dozens of Russian cities and in Kazakhstan, Belarus and Armenia unable to order taxis or access banking services, according to Russian independent news outlet Astra. Russia and Ukraine are locked in a long-range aerial war while their armies remain largely deadlocked on the front line, more than 4.5 years since Moscow's full-scale invasion. Ukraine's strikes on data centres follow Russian attacks on data hubs in Ukraine.

"As a result of the drone attack, the infrastructure of Yandex's data centre in Vladimir was damaged. Operations at the data centre have been completely halted. There were no injuries," said the Yandex Cloud Telegram channel, which provides operational updates on service availability. On Thursday, a drone attack took a Yandex data centre offline in the Ryazan region, southeast of Moscow. A day later, Ukrainian drones hit the company's major data centre in the Kaluga region, southwest of Moscow, partly putting it out of action, Yandex said.

Yandex, often described as Russia's Google, runs the country's most popular search engine and a wide range of digital services, and is heavily involved in Russia's artificial intelligence development.

Elsewhere, Zelenskyy said search and rescue operations ended in the southern city of Zaporizhzhia after a Russian bombing on Saturday, Ivan Fedorov, the former regional head and co-chair of the regional defence council, said Sunday. (*AP*)

Trump sticks with tariffs even as US voters turn against them

BERNARD CONDONAP
New York

Maybe President Donald Trump really does believe that "tariff" is the most beautiful word in the dictionary.

Despite higher prices, criticism from trade experts and displeasure among voters, Trump holds fast to his belief that imposing the highest import duties on US trading partners since the Great Depression is a winner.

A recent poll suggests that is a big gamble with less than a month before the November 3 midterms. Most US adults disapprove of his trade policies, with more than 64 per cent saying he has gone too far with his latest tariffs, compared with 58 per cent in January. A look at the political, legal and economic challenges to the Republican president's approach to trade. The United States has set taxes on imports from most countries in the low double digits, although the rates have gone up and down because of legal setbacks as well as Trump's habit of changing



US president Donald J Trump

them seemingly on a whim. In the biggest round last year, Trump levied what he called "reciprocal" tariffs and other duties on dozens of countries. He cited a 1977 law that he said allowed him to act without congressional approval in an economic emergency.

After the Supreme Court struck that down in February, Trump turned to an array of other trade laws to accomplish his goals.

The primary one he is using now, Section 301 of the Trade Act of 1974, allows him to impose tariffs on countries that he believes are engaging in unfair trade practices, such as not adequately enforcing a ban on forced labour. The new duties range from 10 per cent to 12.5 per cent on imports from 60 economies, including big US trading partners such as the European Union, India, Japan, Canada and Mexico.

Trump is taking a sledgehammer to a relatively open global trading system that many mainstream economists think has benefited the US enormously. It has helped boost growth, keep prices low and make US businesses more competitive and often dominant in global industries. The US is the second-largest exporter in the world, after China. It exported USD 3.4 trillion in goods and services last year, far ahead of third place Germany's $ 2.3 trillion. (*AP*)

The Pioneer
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BRIEFLY

Messi scores twice in first game since Argentina retirement



Lionel Messi scored two goals to give him a league-leading 23 this season, and Inter Miami beat D.C. United 4-0.

Luis Suarez also scored twice and German Berterame had two assists for Inter Miami, which snapped a five-match winless skid. Miami had four draws and one loss before Saturday's outburst. Four days after playing his farewell match that ended a 21-year tenure with the Argentine national team, Messi played the entire 90 minutes.

The win was Miami's first since a 7-1 rout of CF Montreal on Aug. 29. It was also the first league win for new coach Cristian "Kily" Gonzalez, who took over Sept. 16.

D.C. United is winless in its last five matches.

Messi scored his first in the 47th minute after Suarez tallied twice in the first half to give Inter Miami a 2-0 lead at the break. Suarez centered a pass near the 6-yard box, where Messi retrieved it and tapped in a shot inside the right post.

Inter Miami padded its lead when Messi struck again in the 60th minute. He received Rodrigo De Paul's pass, dribbled inside the large area and eluded two United defenders to beat goalkeeper Sean Johnson with a shot from 12 yards.

Inter Miami's first scoring threat resulted in Suarez's goal three minutes into the match. Suarez received Berterame's header and beat Johnson with a shot that landed inside the left post.

Suarez made it 2-0 with his second goal in the 39th minute. Johnson deflected Messi's point-blank shot to an open Berterame, who fed Suarez with another header that he retrieved inside the 6-yard box. Suarez then tapped in a shot for his brace. (AP)

New Zealand unveil special jersey for India ODIs



New Zealand will wear a special limited-edition jersey featuring lotus flowers and mandala art during next month's ODI series against India, marking 100 years of sporting ties between the two countries.

The 'Kotahitanga' ODI shirt represents two cultures bound together by their love for cricket with a design that celebrates the shared history and respect between New Zealand and India.

Artists Ben Thomason, Shiv Narandas and Jai Pancha have collaborated on the shirt design, New Zealand Cricket said.

Narandas and Pancha have used three Indian motifs as the unifying elements; the lotus – India's national flower, a repeating ogee pattern drawn from Indian architecture, and the mandala to provide a symmetrical framework aligning naturally with Maori design systems.

While Thomason weaved traditional Maori abstract painted scroll designs and motifs – kowhaiwhai – over a background of haehae lines to connect the living with those who have passed, honour the people who built the bond between the nations, and celebrate what it means to players, fans and those behind the scenes.

NZC Chief Marketing and Commercial Officer Glenn Critchley said "We're absolutely wrapped with the design. The artists have created a beautiful balance between a distinct Maori design and a distinct Indian design that speaks to the bond between our nations.

"Sport underpins the unity between New Zealand and India and we hope this shirt will be a collector's item treasured by New Zealand and Indian cricket fans for years to come."

Narandas, whose family hails from India, said it was a meaningful project to work on. "This shirt feels like a journey of our life here. hope that everyone can feel the energy that's been put into this project and they can wear the shirt with pride," Narandas said.

The India tour of New Zealand gets underway with the five-match T20I series on October 22, which will be followed by five ODIs beginning November 4. (*PTI*)

Abhishek, Arshdeep power India to 14-run win over WI

DEVARCHIT VARMA
Indore

Abhishek Sharma's scintillating 69 and pacer Arshdeep Singh's crucial three-wicket haul paved the way for India's 14-run victory against the West Indies in the third T20I here on Sunday.

India now lead the five-match series 2-1.

Abhishek's 30-ball knock (6x4, 5x4) and his century alliance with Ishan Kishan (37) drove India's charge with the bat which was undone a bit by sloppy effort in the middle-overs. India made 223 all out.

In reply, Arshdeep Singh (3/44) dealt a severe blow early when he cleaned up in-form WI skipper Shai Hope (5) in the second over, and



Arshdeep Singh celebrates the wicket of West Indies' captain Shai Hope during the third T20I cricket match between India and West Indies in Indore, Madhya Pradesh on Sunday PTI

accounted for Sherfane Rutherford (32) and Keemo Paul (10) later in the innings to seal the outcome of the contest. The West Indies finished at 209 for seven.

The Caribbean side failed to recover from the early dismissal of Hope. Shimron Hetmyer (43, 26b; 4x6, 6x2) got a lifeline early, but he did not really capitalise.

Hetmyer, who looked in rhythm for a long haul which the West Indies needed, was cleaned up by Naman Dhir with an angled in delivery in the seventh over.

In the 10th over, Rovman Powell (5) perished trying to clear the ropes off Axar Patel. Kamil Pooran (42, 27b; 6x3, 4x6) was struggling to middle the ball halfway through the chase. Pooran seemed to have shrugged off his struggles in the 11th over when he sent the ball into the stands thrice off Dhir (2/39), but the bowler had the last laugh, getting him caught by Arshdeep at square leg.

India vice-captain Tilak Varma, who was run out embarrassingly earlier in the first half, redeemed himself with two sharp catches in the deep as India continued tightening their grip on the game. Earlier, a sloppy batting approach in the middle overs took the shine off opener Abhishek's sprightly 69 on a track with some variable bounce.

Abhishek's fiery knock came off 30 balls (6x6, 5x4) and his 108-run stand for the second wicket off only 40 balls with Kishan had put India on course for a massive total. But India slipped from 115 for one to 223 all out, which included a brain fade from Tilak (28) in the 17th over. Tilak ran himself out while not even attempting to get back to the non-strikers' end. Axar's hit was saved at the ropes by Pooran, but the Indian batters thought they had got a boundary. Having met at the middle of the pitch after completing a single, Axar got back into the crease in time before the stumps were broken.

But Tilak was still strolling back and was caught well short of the crease when Gudakesh Motie broke the stumps off the throw from the stumper. Shortly after that, Axar (20) himself was run-out after a mix-up with Arshdeep. Earlier at the start, a few deliveries kept lower than expected, but it all changed the moment Abhishek unleashed himself. (*PTI*)

New Zealand name split ODI squad for India series

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Wellington

Finn Allen, Lockie Ferguson, and Tim Seifert will make their return to New Zealand's ODI setup, while Rachin Ravindra returns from a shoulder injury for the upcoming five-match series against India beginning November 4. Due to the Test series that follows the white-ball games, the selectors have named a split squad, withdrawing red-ball specialists after the third match.

The New Zealand selectors have split the squad into three groups, with only six players — Mitchell Santner (captain), Michael Bracewell, Mark Chapman, Jacob Duffy, Will Young, and Blair Tickner — named for all five ODIs.

Devon Conway, Matt Henry, Kyle Jamieson, Tom Latham, Daryl Mitchell, Glenn Phillips, Rachin Ravindra, and Nathan Smith will feature exclusively in the first three matches starting with game at Eden Park in Auckland. Following the third game, these Test specialists will leave squad to prepare for longer format in Wellington.

To fill the vacancies for the final two ODIs, seven additional players — including Finn Allen, Kristian Clarke, Matt Fisher, Lockie Ferguson, Mitch Hay, Nick Kelly, and Seifert — will join the squad. The BLACKCAPS will look to build on their historic 2-1 ODI series triumph over India on Indian soil in January, their first-ever bilateral ODI series victory in the country.



New Zealand Captain Mitchell Santner FILE PHOTO

Allen and Ferguson last featured in an ODI in 2023, with Ferguson's previous appearance coming in the World Cup semifinal against India in Mumbai. Seifert last played an ODI around 18 months ago during New Zealand's home series against Pakistan.

White-ball captain Mitchell Santner will lead the extended squad, which largely retains the core of the team that secured the landmark series win earlier this year.

Ravindra, who was ruled out of New Zealand's T20I squad due to a shoulder injury, will return for the opening three ODIs.

The squad will undergo a change midway through the series, with several players heading to Wellington after the third match to prepare for the upcoming Test series. Seven additional players will join the ODI squad for the final two games. The five-match series will conclude with the fourth and fifth ODIs. Head coach Rob Walter said the ODI series is very significant considering the 2027 ICC Men's World Cup in South Africa, Zimbabwe, and Namibia. "First and foremost this is huge series for us, playing in front of our fans in full stadiums against a formidable Indian side," he said.

"With ODI World Cup just one year away it's important for us to also view these matches as preparation for that event," he said.

Vaibhav is unreal talent: Ferguson



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Wellington

New Zealand pacer Lockie Ferguson is looking forward to the challenge of bowling to 15-year-old batting sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi in the upcoming T20I series, saying it is "no surprise" the teenager has been pushed into the Indian squad.

Sooryavanshi has been named in India's squad for the five-match series against New Zealand, beginning October 22. "I played him in the IPL. He's proper talent. He's unreal talent. It's no surprise that he's been pushed into the Indian squad. I think he's done IPL back-to-back seasons and been exceptional," Ferguson told reporters on Sunday.

"So yeah, looking forward to a challenge that comes with New Zealand. Obviously it's his first time here, I imagine. I'm not sure if he's played cricket here before. But yeah, it's going to be an awesome series." New Zealand host India for a multi-format series featuring two Tests, five T20Is and as many ODIs. "India's unreal side, we know that. But hosting them in New Zealand is going to be real awesome," he said.

The 35-year-old has been part of the IPL for close to a decade, representing five teams, including former champions Kolkata Knight Riders and Gujarat Titans, and said his experience of playing alongside and against Indian players has helped him understand their approach to the game.

"It's been awesome to play against them (Indian players) and with them at the IPL. So learning how they prepare for games and how they go about playing cricket in India, which can be challenging for good or bad. I've got lots of great mates."

"I know Arshdeep's looking forward to bowling in New Zealand where the ball swings and bounces a bit extra." Ferguson is also set to return to New Zealand's ODI set-up after three years, having been named in the squad for the fourth and fifth matches against India. His last appearance in the format was the 2023 World Cup semi-final against India in Mumbai.

"Yeah, of course. It's something we've been working towards. I suppose with One-Day Cricket World Cup around the corner, we were playing a lot more One-Day cricket.

"T20 was the focus until the World Cup earlier this year, so that's certainly nice to be building up an exciting group for the series. "We've got the T20 series beforehand, but I've been working real hard the last few months to get the body in a good shape to show my skills again for the one day team."

On the evolution of bowling in T20 cricket, Ferguson said the format had influenced the game across formats, forcing bowlers to keep developing their skills.

"It has evolved a lot. The T20 games pushed all of cricket forward, even through Test cricket now, with the speed that batters bat. But it actually makes it more exciting. But you have to develop your skills. I love learning. I love trying to develop.

"Love talking to the younger bowlers, see how they go about it and also try to learn off, you know, the older bowlers and guys who have done it for a long time when I travel the world. So keep trying to push my game forward. It's all you can do. And take opportunities when they come your way."

Smriti Mandhana named celebrity advocate by UNICEF India

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi

Newly appointed India women's cricket captain Smriti Mandhana has been named a celebrity advocate by UNICEF India, with the organisation seeking to leverage her influence to promote equal opportunities, health and well-being for adolescent girls.

The announcement was made on Sunday to mark the International Day of the Girl, which draws attention to girls' rights, safety, leadership and potential, while highlighting the barriers that continue to restrict their choices.

In her new role, Mandhana will build on her previous association with initiatives promoting equal



rights and opportunities for children and young people, and advocate for an environment in which girls can participate in sports and realise their potential.

She will also support UNICEF India's efforts to empower adolescent girls, improve their health and well-being, and help them access opportunities to learn, play and lead.

"I am deeply honoured to join UNICEF India as a Celebrity Advocate. Growing up playing cricket taught me that every dream begins with an opportunity.

"With hard work, determination, and encouragement, that opportunity can turn into something extraordinary. Every child and young person deserves the chance to dream big and reach their full potential," Mandhana said.

The left-handed batter has previously supported UNICEF and International Cricket Council campaigns focusing on gender equality and life skills, besides lending her support to UNICEF's Promise to Children campaign.

An Arjuna Award recipient, Mandhana was appointed captain of the Indian women's cricket team earlier this week after Harmanpreet Kaur stepped down from the role.

From playing with Gill and Yuvraj to making debut for Australia, Nikhil Chaudhary lives a dream

G UNNIKRISHNAN
Bengaluru

Nikhil Chaudhary had his return tickets booked from Australia after a holiday with his uncle's family in Cairns, and was eager to join his Punjab teammates ahead of the 2020-21 domestic season. An IPL contract was in his dreams.

But as fate would have it, the Covid-19 pandemic and the ensuing worldwide lockdown upended his plans, keeping him Down Under.

However, that three months of uncertain period opened up fresh opportunities for Chaudhary, culminating in him making international debut for Australia in a T20I match against Bangladesh in June this year. The goose-bumps are still there.

"It was my life's biggest moment. Six years ago, when I was going to Australia for a holiday, who could have imagined that I would be playing in Australia? Not even my parents would actually have thought of that," Chaudhary, who is in Puducherry with Australia A to play three 50-over games against India A, told PTI in an interview facilitated by Cricket Australia.

"I was in Belgium playing in a T20 league when I got the call from Tony (Dodemaide, former player and one of the Australian selectors). Australia is one of best countries to have played cricket ever. So, it's not easy to get into it. But to be honest, I'm very grateful."

"All the opportunities I'm getting are because of my performance, the hard work I've put in from last five, six years in my life. I think it's a matter of time before more opportunities come to my life. I just need to keep working hard and trust the process."

Chaudhary had an impactful 2025-26 Big Bash League season for Hobart Hurricanes, scoring 307 runs from 12 matches at a strike rate of 154. It made the Aussie selectors notice him.

Chaudhary, who once



played alongside Yuvraj Singh and Shubman Gill for Punjab in 2017, traced the turnaround in his life to that extended stay in Australia in 2020.

"I left India, I think on 16th of March, landed in Cairns, Queensland. I got stuck there for almost three months because of Covid, and remember I had my return ticket back to India ready, on 7th of May after my birthday (May 4).

"So, I started playing in Brisbane. I moved from Cairns to Brisbane around June because the season starts early September there. I have some friends there, and through them I joined Northern Suburban District Club." But the moment of truth came soon for him.

"I got a phone call from our Punjab selector that I have made it to the Ranji Trophy team. I had to make a quick decision. Then I had a chat with my coach, Charanjit Singh Pangu in Ludhiana, and with mom and dad.

"They were like, nah, you got to come back. You have done all this hard work to be in this stage to play for your state along with India players like Gill and Yuvraj (in 2017 Vijay Hazare Trophy). You're going to go further from here and hopefully play IPL etc.

"But I told them I think I've got my happy place here. That's when I actually made the decision of staying in Brisbane," he said.

But was it tough for him to stay away from his family in a culturally different land?

"Yeah, obviously, the culture difference is more regarding the aspects of life, which is doing everything by yourself, not having enough help from your family or close ones. Everyone in Australia builds their own life by scratching from the start. "You have to do some odd jobs. Even school students, when they are 15, 16, work at McDonald's. I did for Australia Post. Those things help you when you make a career of yourself."

But the 30-year-old had some experience of living on his own during the BCCI age-group camps, which he said, helped him adapt to the Aussie living. "Obviously, in India, you live with your parents most of your life. And then that comfort zone, you actually don't go out of that because you are too emotionally attached. It's not just about money. "So again, that's where there was a big cultural difference. Being able to stay away from home from under-14, obviously, you play under 14, 16 for your state. There are north, northeast zone camps, everything. So, you stay away from your family. So, I was actually used to it," he explained.

This deep-rooted familiarity with cricket from a young age came handy when he transitioned from white ball formats to red-ball first-class cricket in Australia at 29.

"See, when I played the Big Bash for the first time, I was almost turning 27. That's a bit late to get a contract. But I knew what impact I can make to the team and to the game. I need the challenge to get the best out of me.

"It's always the white ball which can challenge me the most because I'm always in game. But I had to wait to get qualified to play for Australia, and it actually made me a better person. I was lucky enough to play with players like Tim David, Matthew Wade, Ben McDermott, Nathan Ellis etc." But was it tough to adapt to Shield cricket?

"There wasn't a big transition, to be honest, because from under 14, 16 in India, we always play with red ball. So, it wasn't something new. Even in Australia, we play red ball cricket for the club in Premiership.

"And then, last year, I got the opportunity for Tasmania to play Shield cricket. And even straight away in first game, I got the fifer and scored an 80-odd to save the game. That's when everyone knew that I am an all-format player," he said. In that context, Chaudhary feels the current trip to India will add more arrows to his quiver. (*PTI*)